

AN ACHE PRESENTATION

The Hotwife Cruise



Cassandra



KENNY WRIGHT

HOTWIFE CRUISE: CASSANDRA

KENNY WRIGHT

K&W

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PREFACE

This has been an interesting writing experience. You're probably aware that this book is the last in a "series" of books called *The Hotwife Cruise*. I put series in quotes because each novel is independent of the other, and no prior knowledge is required to enjoy any of them. Check the back matter of this book for links to everyone else's book.

All books take place during the same cruise, aboard the same ship, *The Princess of Desire*, as it sails through the Caribbean. Each book focuses on a different couple (or set of characters) with some fun overlaps at times.

Going last in this series has been fun because I've had the privilege of reading everyone else's book. This has let me weave in some of the details and characters from the other works, like easter eggs for those who enjoy the sort of thing. And since this *is* a cruise ship made for couples in the hotwife and cuckold lifestyle, you'll find some cameos from my own books.

I'm really happy with how this book came together. It's a different kind of story than what I typically write, and what started as just a fun lark that Paul Garland invited me into has turned into a meaningful tale about the pitfalls of the lifestyle, what it means to be a hotwife and a husband, and second chances at love.

I'd like to thank all of my fellow authors in this endeavor: GK Grayson, Kirsten McCurran, Skylar Quinn, Delores Swallows, and Hardison Parker. Special thanks goes to Paul Garland, who put in the leg work to organize us

and try to maintain some form of consistency across all books, including coming up with our shared cast, doing our covers, and helping to market it. Huge thanks to my editor, Miles, who's absolutely amazing.

Thanks to my patrons for offering their honest feedback as I posted it earlier this month, and thanks to you for purchasing!

Leave a review if you liked what you read, and enjoy!

Faye paused on the gangway, turning back to stare at Austin, her blue eyes filled with wonder. “Can you believe all this?” Her golden hair caught the glint of the bright Miami sun. She’d cut it into a chin-length bob for this trip, and the new look only further enhanced her elegant beauty, showing off her graceful neck and bare shoulders. And as was so often the case with his wife, caused Austin’s breath to catch in his throat.

Behind her rose the Princess of Adventure like a small floating city of glass and steel. It was their first cruise together, and what a cruise this was. Other couples flowed past them, boarding the ship with the kind of nervous anticipation normally reserved for kids arriving at camp.

Only this camp was adults-only—a lifestyle cruise that catered to men who enjoyed watching their wives with other men. And, of course, to the women they both loved and loved to share.

A pulse of anxiety ran through Austin as he grappled with that idea once again. He looked away from the towering windows and balconies of the ship, back to Faye. She was checking out some guy who’d just moved past her—a muscular young stud with dark-chocolate skin and seemingly without a companion. He grinned at Faye, who smiled back at him before shooting an excited look in Austin’s direction.

His stomach was doing flips at the exchange, and they hadn’t even made it onto the actual ship. Faye held her hand out to her husband, and when he threaded his fingers through hers, he was surprised to find them

clammy. She never seemed nervous, and it was nice to discover that she was.

“Austin, this is going to be so much fun,” she said, pulling him against her as they finally stepped aboard the cruise ship. “I can’t believe that we’re here.”

“Definitely not a city council function,” he said. A caterer passed by, holding a tray of champagne. It was a bit early for drinking, but when Faye passed him one, he took it like a life preserver.

“To making memories,” she said, clinking her glass against his before he had the chance to even raise it.

“To memories.” He downed half of his glass. They continued onto the ship, passing into the luxurious atrium at its heart, Faye one step ahead of her husband the whole time, swaying provocatively on her strappy gold sandals with their sky-high heels that clicked as she walked along the deck.

Austin was a handsome man, his blond hair cut into a mid fade, then parted high—a style courtesy mostly of Faye. The short and tidy beard was also Faye’s idea, although he liked the look. In his polo shirt and khaki shorts, he *looked* like he was on vacation. He just didn’t feel it.

“God, so much eye candy,” Faye said to herself as she sipped her champagne.

In addition to the couples that made up most of the passengers, a few unattached men seemed to be scoping out the women. Faye drew her fair share of smiles and nods, and each smile and nod felt like a fist in Austin’s gut.

Like he always did in these situations, he went with it, turning his charm on his wife.

“Tell me about it,” he said, exaggerating the way his eyes swept across his wife. Wearing a white, strapless sundress that clung to her statuesque body, Faye knew she looked good and never minded showing off.

Her makeup was flawless—smokey eyes, perfectly arched brows, lips painted a bold, seductive red. Gold hoop earrings caught the light as she tipped her head to one side, her blonde bob tipping as well, and grinned at Austin.

“Such a charmer, honey,” she said, reaching out to trace her red-painted nails along his cheek. “Keep it up and maybe I’ll let you worship me when we get to our cabin.”

“Let’s go,” Austin said, reaching for his wife’s hand. She’d been edging him for the last two weeks, forbidding him from even jerking off to completion. He was so ready for that sweet release.

“Now, now,” she said, taking her fingers away and turning back to their surroundings. “All in good time.”

A chime rang out over the intercom, and a man’s voice came on, accented with a subtle Spanish.

“Welcome aboard, this is Captain Rodriguez speaking. I know you all are anxious to get out to sea, but before we set sail, let me introduce you to our cruise director, Felicity Jones, who will introduce you to all the wondrous services we have on this trip, as we taxi out of the docking zone. Oh, and we are proud to be hosting the Emancipated and their hotwives, cucks, and bulls! They’re all yours, Felicity.”

Faye squeezed Austin’s arm, bouncing in her heels with giddiness. A woman came over the intercom, clearing her throat before speaking with sweet, bubbly confidence.

“Hello everybody. This is Felicity Jones, your Cruise Director. You won’t believe what we have in store for you. Everyone is dripping with anticipation as we take you to the edge of paradise.”

All around them, couples had paused to listen to the announcement, laughing with the same nervous excitement that Austin felt. That was nice. At least he wasn’t totally alone in feeling that.

“Just a reminder to our takeover guests,” the cruise director continued. “Please remember that the private adult activities are restricted to areas designated Platinum. Please be courteous of any guests not partaking in the fun and remember, consent is mandatory.”

“Who would come on this cruise and not play?” Faye asked aloud. She wasn’t looking for an answer, and Austin kept his mouth shut, but he wondered if he counted as part of that. Not that he didn’t enjoy it when Faye had fun. He loved that she loved it so much, but were it up to him, he’d probably enjoy a more vanilla cruise.

Felicity finished off her welcome as the ship shifted beneath them. They were finally off, which drew a round of excited applause from the passengers around them.

“We should find one of these platinum areas,” Faye said.

“We should find our cabin first. Just so we know where all of our things are.”

Faye pouted, and for a moment Austin wondered if she'd insist they get right down to business. She reached out, straightening the collar on his polo shirt, and nodded. "Okay, fine. Let's get settled in first."

They swung by the check-in counter to get their room's keycard and a map of the facilities. There were a lot of fun locations to explore: a casino, a spa, bars and lounges, even a club named The Starlight Ballroom, not to mention a number of fun, thematic pools throughout the ship. They also got the itinerary for the eight day cruise.

"Oh, there's a 'glow' party tomorrow night," Faye said on their way to the room. "We should do that."

"A glow party?"

Faye read from the brochure as she navigated the passageways of the interior of the ship, reading: "Light up the night at our sizzling Glow Party! Wear your sexiest neon attire and let the pulsing beats lead you astray. Explore the tantalizing darkness and discover all sorts of naughty surprises. Visit our body painting booths to become a living canvas, then compete for 'Most Creative Decoration.' Anything goes...if you dare!"

"So it's a rave."

"You say that like it's a bad thing," Faye said. "Come on, doesn't it sound fun? Didn't you ever go to a rave when you were younger?"

"Can't say that I did."

She paused, turning to him. "Sometimes I forget how sheltered you were."

It wasn't exactly fair. Austin had gone to college in a small town, and when he'd graduated, he'd worked in a town not much bigger, far from the cities. He liked that life. It's just that Faye, well, didn't.

"I think the Nassau excursion sounds fun," he said, changing the subject. They continued towards their rooms.

"And St. Thomas," she added. "And St. Maarten's. Oh, I'm *so* excited." Somehow, despite barely looking at the map, Faye had found their rooms. That's how she seemed to navigate life—despite seeming to be carefree, she always had everything under control. "Here we are."

Austin was surprised to see how spacious their room aboard the Princess of Adventure was. He'd never been on a cruise before, but he was half expecting bunks and a small porthole for a window. Instead, they had a nice, queen-sized bed, a sitting area, and a balcony that looked out on the ocean.

“Wow, this is amazing,” he said. Their bags were already set neatly against the wall, where the porter had delivered them earlier. Faye went to hers as Austin slid open the balcony doors. The ocean air greeted him as he stepped out and took it all in. Miami was already in the distance to his right, a seam of jagged land.

No going back now. Not that he really had much of an option before. Faye had decided that they were going to do this cruise, and once she set her mind to something, there was very little Austin could do to change it.

Like how they’d moved to her own hometown of Philadelphia. Or how she’d insisted on paying for an interior designer when they’d moved into their new home. Or how she helped him with his wardrobe.

Or how they’d gotten into hotwifing.

Now here they were, aboard a cruise designed specifically for wives to fuck other men.

Despite all of his reservations, he couldn’t help feel the ripple of excitement up his spine at the thought. There was no doubt that he got excited by all of this. He could almost hear Faye’s moans on the ocean breeze, the sound of her getting plowed by her latest stud, until he realized that it was quite likely a neighbor actually getting plowed at that very moment.

“Mmm, see? Someone’s already getting started,” Faye said, interrupting his thoughts as she came up behind him. Her tanned arms wrapped around him from behind, one tracing his broad chest, the other moving down between his legs. “I wonder if she’s getting it from hubby, or someone new.”

Austin’s cock jumped as she fondled him, her lips leaving goosebumps where they kissed his neck. He came alive, turning his head to meet her lips with his own. Only she pulled back, a cruel smile dancing on her beautiful face.

“Now who’s eager?” she asked, raising a brow.

“You’ve been denying me since before Christmas.”

As she stepped back, he realized that she’d changed into her bikini. She looked amazing—all long lean limbs, tanned skin, subtle curves. Her string bikini was a new one that he didn’t recognize, off-white with a gold chain at her hips and around her neck. The cut accentuated her breasts, and when she turned to head towards the door, he realized that the back plunged between her cheeks.

“Then a few more hours won’t kill you,” she said.

He stared at her. Faye was flashy and confident, but that bikini was a lot, even for her. “You’re going to go out dressed like that?”

“No, silly,” she said, plucking a short sarong and tying it around her waist. It barely touched the tops of her thighs, and was mostly see-through. Anyone looking would see the thong. “I’ll wear this, too. Now hurry up and get ready. I’ll be by the pool up on the top deck, and you won’t want to miss any of the action.”

“OH MY... OHHHH YESSS...” Cassandra writhed on the bed, running her fingers through her lush, golden locks. “That feels... sooooo fucking good.”

She was on her back, naked, as her husband Marshall feasted on her moist sex. His tongue swirled and danced across her clit, wet and warm slashes of pure pleasure, as he drove two fingers in and out of her. As good as it all felt, it was the way he looked up at her, the way their eyes met over the curves of her body, that electrified the moment.

Marshall pulled his mouth away but kept working his fingers inside of her. “Talk dirty for me, baby.”

“Fuck me with your mouth.” Her words spilled out easily—both with practice, and with how close she was to the edge. “Eat me, honey. Put your lips back on my smooth mound and make me come.”

She could practically see his pupils dilate at the naughty words. Once, that had been hard. Once, she’d been so timid. Now—

“I love how good your mouth feels on my waxed cunt.”

Her husband sucked in air like a bull ready to charge, dropping back down onto her, redoubling his efforts. She arched back, filling her hands with her large breasts, teasing her nipples as she inched closer and closer to sweet release.

Cassandra was close. She was so close. She could feel her orgasm as surely as she could feel the sea breeze roll across her sweat-slick skin. It was there. It was *right there*—

“No!” she cried as Marshall pulled away.

“No, indeed.” He shook his head at her, grinning ruefully. “I know what you’re doing, and it’s not going to work, Cassie.”

“Please, Marshall, I’ll... I’ll do anything.”

He lifted a brow at the offer, and for a second, Cassandra hoped that he’d take her up on it. But in the end, he shook his head. “You’ll do anything regardless.” Bending down, he gave her one last kiss on the top of her waxed mound. She shuddered. “But I think it would be more exciting if you were thoroughly edged.”

Cassandra flopped onto her back and stared up at the ceiling, sighing in frustration. “That’s not nice.”

“Get dressed. I’ll buy you a drink to make it up to you.”

“The drinks are free here.”

“Then I’ll find you a big, hard stunt cock to take care of you.”

“I’d rather have *your* cock,” she said, trying one last time.

But Marshall wasn’t having it. He stood back and rolled his shoulders back. She peeked over at him, admiring his lean muscles and the bit of gray in his chest hair. Despite pushing sixty, Marshall was fitter than most of the husbands she’d seen board the Princess of Adventure. He liked it that way. He’d told her more than once that he was a stag amongst cucks, and he had the money and the free time to maintain his impressive physique.

“And I’d rather you bounce on a young stud,” he said, walking across the room, confidently naked. She admired his rear before sighing and sitting up. “And don’t you think it’ll be fun to get out there and show off your newest enhancements?”

She looked down at her breasts. Even after six months she was still getting used to her boob job. The surgeon had done an amazing job, and despite going from a full B cup to double Ds, they looked real. Or at least as real as a pair this large could look on someone her size. Still, after spending most of her adult life at one size, it was a change.

Marshall started getting dressed, slipping into a Tommy Bahama shirt and a pair of white khakis. He looked good, and she looked good on his arm. Sometimes, she felt like that’s what her life had been reduced to. Not that she hated it. It was just... not what she would have ever expected in a marriage.

She stretched on the bed—a king, and one of the few cabins large enough to sport the bed—and enjoyed the way Marshall’s eyes tracked over to her as she did. Hopping off the bed, she padded barefoot over to her closet, where she’d already unpacked and organized her things. “Did you bring me onto this cruise just to show me off?”

“And to get you fucked,” he said, his eyes fixed on her naked backside.

Cassandra smirked at him over her shoulder before stepping into a sheer, white thong. She was a trophy wife, and had long since stopped fooling herself on that front. Not with the personal dietitian, the trainers, the stylists. Not with the expensive dresses that she only wore once, for a few hours, as they attended some important function or another.

When she was younger, she never dreamed that this was what she’d become, but now, she couldn’t imagine another life. Some accused her of marrying him for his money, but they were wrong. She’d fallen in love with him before the success, before the IPO. She loved his confidence, his charm, and his... dominance.

“Wear the Chanel,” he said, watching her as she searched the rack of designer dresses that they’d brought. “It’ll really compliment your... eyes.”

Cassandra knew the one, pulling it from the hanger. Off-white with red and orange flowers, it had an extremely low neckline. She reached for a bra that matched the thong, and would help emphasize what she knew Marshall wanted emphasized.

The effect was devastating. Her tits looked huge. She was used to being arm candy, but this was over-the-top. Marshall stepped up beside her, putting an arm around her waist. “I look...”

“Fucking delicious,” Marshall said, helping her finish her sentence. His eyes were where every man’s would be, zeroed in on her deep cleavage. “Fucking... irresistible.”

“It’s a bit much, don’t you think?”

“That’s the point. We’re on a sex cruise, Cassie. Everything about this is over-the-top. Did you know that there’s a group of men here who are part of a club called ‘long’?”

“Long?”

“L. O. N. G. The League of Nine-inch Gentlemen.” He chuckled. “A club so exclusive that even I can’t gain membership.”

“That sounds... painful.”

He laughed, thinking that she was making a joke. “Don’t tell me you’re not curious.”

Cassandra wasn’t. She enjoyed a big dick, but that was beyond big. Still, she’d learned the art of turning these doubts into foreplay. “So is that your fantasy, Marsh?” She turned into him, pressing her body to his. “Want to watch me get taken by some huge cock?”

The whole lifestyle was more Marshall's thing than hers, but it did have its perks.

She felt his fingers slide down her backside before he could stop himself. Then he backed off with a chuckle. "You're doing it again, Cassie. And this time, I may need to punish you."

"Your fault," she said, kissing him chastely on the lips. "You made me this way."

She spun away and slipped into a pair of cork-heeled sandals, hearing all the different ways to interpret that last statement. *Fine*, she thought, *if he wants a hotwife, I'll give him a hotwife*.

The Nautical Nook Bar reminded Austin of a ship's wheel. The large, circular bar sat at the center of the space, and almost sunken into the floor, acting as the hub. Around the outside, like spokes of the wheel, were the nooks, round, recessed booths that overlooked the room and provided privacy. Austin couldn't see into them, which was the point.

"We can add you to the waitlist for one of the nooks," the maitre d' said apologetically. "I'm sorry, but first night on the ship, things are a little crowded."

"It's fine," Faye said, eyeing the people who were mingling at the bar, flirting over drinks. "We can wait down there?"

"That's fine. You're welcome to sit at the bar."

Faye ran her fingers along the maitre d's cheek. "Perfect, sweetheart. Austin, make sure we're on the list."

She was already descending the steps towards the bar before Austin even gave the host his number. "We'll send you a text once a nook opens up," the man said. Austin barely heard him, keenly aware that his wife was walking into a pit of vipers.

Or maybe that was just a description of his stomach?

By the time he'd rejoined her, Faye was engrossed in a conversation with another couple, a few years younger than them. They were good looking, both with dark hair and matching slightly bewildered expressions.

“This is my husband, Austin.” Faye threaded her hands around his arm. “This is Kate and Jordan.”

Like always, Faye had a way of talking like she was already good friends with this couple, even though Austin was pretty sure they’d just met.

“Jordan here didn’t know what a hotwife was when he booked this cruise.” Faye’s eyes wide with delight. “Can you imagine?”

Jordan glanced at his wife, flushed. “Well, I mean, Kate is hot. And she’s my wife.”

“She is definitely hot,” Faye said, eyeing the athletic brunette. Shooting a quick look at Austin, she added, “But don’t get any ideas, Austin.”

Kate watched the exchange with curiosity. “So he doesn’t get to play?”

Faye shook her head. “He’s my little cuck. My pleasure is his pleasure.”

Austin felt that familiar pang of humiliation as this seemingly innocent couple looked at him, then at one another, like they’d suddenly found themselves *inside* the cages at the zoo.

“That’s... supportive of you,” Jordan said. He glanced at his wife again, as if to communicate, *Don’t get any ideas*.

“Well, it was nice meeting you,” Kate said, sensing her husband’s unease. “Maybe we’ll see you around.”

Austin felt a pang of envy as he watched them go. Where Kate had the instinct to protect, Faye would doubtless have twisted the knife harder.

“She was cute,” Faye whispered, running her fingers through Austin’s closely cropped beard. “And she seemed to like the look of you.”

“Faye...”

“What? I happen to be proud to have a hot husband.” She kissed his cheek. “Just as long as you don’t become a *hothusband*.”

“That’s not a thing.”

“You know what I mean.”

They ordered some cocktails as they waited for a table to open up. A live band struck up some music, and a few of the guests filtered onto the small dance floor. Austin noticed that the young couple was among them.

Austin wondered what it could be like if things were more equal. He enjoyed watching Faye with other men, and he got off on her sexual dynamism, but sometimes the humiliating aspects got to be a bit much. Kate and Jordan seemed more... balanced. Or maybe they were just overwhelmed by this lifestyle cruise.

“I can’t believe they didn’t know about...” He turned to Faye, only to see her talking with a new guy. His heart rate immediately kicked up a notch, and he could feel his palms go clammy. As always. This was the feeling that he loved and hated, and couldn’t get enough of. It was like the first hit of a drug of the evening—not that he did drugs—and it was also the first thrust of the knife.

The guy looked quite a bit younger than them, probably still in his twenties, with light black skin, short black hair, and the swagger of a man who knew he was hot shit.

These moments were always awkward for Austin. He never knew what to do. Did he engage in their conversation? Did he wander away and give them space? Probably better than what he normally did, which was to stand there impotently, nodding along even though he could only hear half of their hushed and heated conversation.

The bull’s name was Joe Greene. That much Austin put together. And Joe knew that he was with Faye, but after that, Austin may as well have been nonexistent. Maybe there had been a time when this felt good, felt sexy, felt like he was sharing an experience with his wife. Not anymore. And not for a long time.

He just kept ordering drinks—amazing how dangerous a drink plan could be on these cruises—and searching the crowd like there was something out there to save him.

His eyes kept landing on a stacked blonde wearing a slinky white dress, decorated with flowers. Something about her reminded him of an ex-girlfriend, Cassandra, although it couldn’t be. While Cassandra had been curvy, she didn’t have tits like that woman, not the platinum blonde hair, nor the confidence to pull off her whole look. But their mannerisms were similar, idiosyncrasies that he’d once studied from afar before he’d worked up the guts to talk to her. Like the way she tipped her head and laughed, her eyes turning into half-moons of joy, or her upright posture as she stood, lost in thought.

Austin actually thought about Cassandra quite often. He didn’t have many past girlfriends, he was never a player like that, but she was the one who really made an impression. He often wondered what would have happened if they’d stuck together and tried the long distance thing after he’d moved away.

Faye started to gather her purse. Joe was there, whispering something into her ear that had her giggling. Austin's stomach fluttered and his dick stiffened in his pants. Despite all of his reservations, watching his wife moan like a pornstar still had an effect.

When Austin got to his feet as well, though, the other man seemed to acknowledge him for the first time. Placing a hand on Austin's chest, Joe said, "Not so fast, little man. Private party. By invitation only."

Faye stood, looking amused, watching Austin, and didn't come to his defense.

"I..." Austin looked at his wife, pleading. They usually played together. Faye enjoyed having him there, helplessly watching. Austin liked it, too. But she'd gone off alone before, and that angst was a different kind of pleasure-pain.

"You'll sit here and wait for us," Joe said. He patted Austin's cheek before stepping back and sliding his hand into Faye's. "And while you wait, I want you to think about what's happening to your wife. I want you to imagine my big, hard cock stretching her perfect little pussy. I want you to picture her moaning and screaming my name as I make her cum over and over again."

Faye just chuckled, her eyes never leaving Austin's. Austin was hot with humiliation, as well as arousal. He didn't like that this turned him on, but like a house-broken dog, he knew not to pee in the house anymore.

When his phone buzzed in his pocket, he jumped and nearly blew his load. When he pulled it out, he saw that their table was ready.

"Looks like we have..." But Joe was already leading Faye away. "...a nook."

Feeling excluded yet oddly aroused, and conflicted about being so aroused, he went back to the bar and ordered another drink.

"Austin? Is that... is that you?"

He recognized the voice, although when he followed it, he didn't recognize the woman. Not at first. It was the blonde that he'd checked out earlier. But it couldn't be...

"Cassandra?"

The blonde blushed, glancing down and away, and then he saw past the makeup and the hair and the tits. It *was* Cassandra. He'd recognize that demure modesty anywhere.

"Hey, Austin. Long time, no see."

Cassandra was used to men looking at her a certain way. She'd cultivated a very specific look over the years and she'd long ago come to peace with people's reactions to it.

But it was different with Austin. Austin was a man from before, a man who knew Cassandra in her more innocent years. He was also here on this ship, though, and that was interesting.

"Cassandra, you look... wow." His eyes inevitably landed in her deep cleavage, but unlike most of the men that she'd met aboard the ship, he actually looked sheepish when caught.

"You're not looking so bad yourself. Love the haircut."

When she first saw Austin, looking really good with his trimmed beard and styled hair, she almost didn't recognize him as the skinny guy she'd dated in her early twenties. He'd filled out, and she liked it.

"Oh, um, thanks." He dragged his eyes back to hers. "So how have you been?"

"You mean how have I been in the last fifteen years?" She smiled, feeling the same awkward excitement that seemed to war within Austin.

"Yeah, I guess. Has it been that long?"

"Time flies, right? Buy me a drink and we can catch up."

"Oh, right. I have a..." He raised his phone as though that meant something.

“A date?” She suddenly felt disappointed. Marshall had sent her out to find a man, and while she didn’t *really* intend to bring her ex back to their cabin, now that she couldn’t, she realized that she wanted to. “Then I’ll just let you—”

“No,” Austin barked. “No, I don’t have a date. Just a table.” He waved to the nooks that encircled the bar. “But my... wife’s already moved on.”

She knew that it was unfair, but she felt jealousy at the revelation. Made sense, given the nature of this cruise. Either he was the husband to a hotwife, or he was a single stud brought in to please them, and judging from memory, he wasn’t really the latter. Not that she had any problem with that. She seemed to recall that he knew what to do with his equipment.

“I see,” she said.

They stood there for a moment, fidgeting under the suddenly oppressive silence until Austin eventually figured out that the next obvious action was to invite her to the booth. “Want to...uh...join me? At the table, I mean.”

His awkwardness was adorable. She smiled brightly. “Sounds good. These heels are killing me.”

And of course his eyes immediately traveled down her body, over her shapely legs and further, to her towering stilettos. Her nipples stiffened. Her tummy did little flips.

Marshall was somewhere in the crowd, watching her, but for the first time in the many years that they’d been playing this game, she didn’t seek him out. She was more excited to catch up with Austin.

Things felt very intimate once they had settled into the recessed alcove, sheltered on all sides, with a floor deep enough that no one could see into it. Even the booths on the other side of the ring were shielded by the large chandelier that hung over the bar. Once the server came by and took their orders, it was like they were entirely alone.

“This is nice,” she said.

“Yeah.” Austin looked like he was ready to bolt.

“Kind of reminds me of that time we went camping and it rained all night.”

“Oh, my God, I totally forgot about that. It *poured*.” Austin laughed at the memory. They’d been dating a few months at the time, and had done some hiking together. It had been his suggestion that they camp, and he’d felt so bad when the sky opened up just after they’d gotten the tent set up.

“You were so apologetic,” she said, laughing as well.

“If I’m honest, I was pretty sure that you’d dump me right after that, and I really liked you.”

That landed for Cassandra, even after all of these years. She really liked him, too. Still did. “Well, I didn’t dump you, as you know.”

“And you even went on other camping trips.”

She had. God, that was ages ago. She couldn’t imagine camping with Marshall unless it was more like “glamping,” which involved someone else setting up their camp site, and the tent being more like a luxury yurt.

“Maybe it had something to do with how memorable that first one was.” Because they couldn’t do much outside of the tent that rainy night, they spent a lot of time cuddling together *inside* of the tent. She still had fond memories of that time, the effortless intimacy in that small space, the patter of rain along the nylon canopy, the slow, loving, tender sex.

Beneath the table, she ran her foot up along Austin’s leg. He jumped at the touch, his eyes widening in surprise. When he shifted away subtly, Cassandra went hot with embarrassment. “I’m sorry, too forward.”

“No, it’s okay,” Austin stammered. “I’m just... this is all new to me.”

“Really?” *He came on a lifestyle cruise as a newbie?*

“I mean, not, like, totally new. But I’m not... I don’t normally participate... like that. My wife, she...”

“I see. She’s not comfortable with sharing you.”

Austin nodded. Their drinks arrived, breaking some of the tension. Cassandra raised a glass. “To your wife. She’s a lucky woman.”

Austin clinked his glass to hers, nodding mutely.

“What’s her name?” she asked.

“Faye.”

Cassandra could hear the affection he had for his wife in the reverent way he said her name, as well as the discomfort he seemed to have as he met her eyes. He probably wasn’t even allowed to talk to other women. Not surprising. Even back in when they were dating Austin seemed to have these rule-abiding tendencies. “And yours?”

“Marshall.” Saying his name broke some kind of spell for Cassandra. They were no longer secreted away in the tent in the rain anymore, alone in the world together. They were back aboard the Princess, surrounded by horny couples looking to get laid. Which is what she was supposed to be doing.

And yet all of a sudden, she *didn’t* want that. Not yet.

“You still working with animals?” he asked. Apparently Austin wasn’t ready to dive back into the present either.

“In a sense.” When they’d dated, years ago, she’d been a receptionist at a veterinary clinic. “I have horses now.”

She braced for his inevitable judgment—for his eyes to dip into her cleavage again and write her off as a gold-digger and trophy wife. The latter wasn’t even entirely unfair.

But he didn’t do any of that. Instead, he smiled broadly and said, “That’s great, Cass,” using her feeble attempt at a college nick-name.

She beamed at him almost in spite of herself. “Been a while since anyone called me that.”

“You always talked about how much you loved horses,” Austin went on as if he hadn’t heard. “How many and what are their names?”

“I have two. Riverstone is an Appaloosa, and Duke is an Andalusian. But we also take care of a few other horses on our property. And we also foster some dogs.”

“That’s so great.”

“Marshall, he does well for himself. Had a big IPO with his tech startup. That was a few years after we got married.” She always inserted that last explanation, as if to tell anyone that she didn’t marry him for his money.

Austin wasn’t looking for the explanation. He seemed genuinely happy for her.

“I’m sure he couldn’t do it without your support.”

She didn’t know about that, but it was a nice thing for Austin to say. Turning things to him, she asked, “And you? Did you end up getting your degree in urban planning?”

It was why he left, and why they broke up.

“I did, although my job has more to do with approving permits for the city government than any type of planning.” He grinned at her. “Good thing you didn’t marry me. Can’t afford horses on a local bureaucrat’s salary.”

“Oh, I don’t *need* horses.” Sometimes she wondered how much they were a way to distract herself.

“Maybe not, but I’m glad that you have them.”

Cassandra reached across the table and took his hand in hers. Their fingers laced together. Their eyes met, and it was like the intervening years just melted away. “You’re, like, still the same guy I knew before.”

Austin chuckled. “No, not quite. Back then, I never would have come on a cruise like this.”

“Same,” Cassandra said. “How funny that we’re both here.” They were still holding hands, she realized, and reluctantly let him go. “Speaking of, I should probably go. Marsh is expecting me to find a...”

All of a sudden she felt embarrassed at what Marshall wanted her to do. Admitting it to Austin, even though he was also there for the same reason, felt awkward.

Comprehension passed across Austin’s face like the sun clearing the clouds. He glanced away from her, breaking eye contact, color springing to his cheeks. “Right, of course.” He forced himself to look back at her. “Whoever you find’s one lucky SOB.”

You could be that guy... She almost said it out loud. But before she could muster the words, both of their phones buzzed at the exact same moment, breaking the spell. Austin reached for his. Cassandra flipped hers over, seeing the text from her husband.

[Marshall]: You’ve been in that booth for quite a while. Hope you’re taking advantage of how private it is...

Cassandra flicked her eyes up towards Austin, who was staring down at his own phone, looking something between troubled and turned on. She recognized that look. She saw it in Marshall’s eyes all the time.

[Cassandra]: I’m getting to know this guy really well.

She felt guilt on a few levels as she typed it out. First, she wasn’t telling Marshall the whole truth. Worse, she was using Austin in a way that seemed like a betrayal of what they had. But her husband’s thirst for this fantasy was bottomless, and she needed to feed him something. She pressed send.

“That Faye?” she asked, turning her phone back down on the table.

Austin hesitated before replying, “Yeah.”

She knew what she would have done in Faye’s situation—what she *had* done. “Photos?” she guessed.

He nodded.

Cassandra slid around the semi-circular booth, getting closer to him. Austin gave her a sidelong glance, but didn’t slide away. “Can I see?”

Austin licked his lips, seemed to want to tell her no, then shrugged. He unlocked his phone again, and the image brought a gasp to Cassandra’s lips.

“She’s hot,” were the first words out of her mouth. But it was more than that. The whole scene was hot.

Austin's wife was straddling a black man's lap, facing the camera with her head thrown back, her eyes shut, her cheeks flushed. Her blonde hair fell around her face, tousled and wild, glistening with sweat, clinging to her face and forehead.

Cassandra's eyes tracked down Faye's body. She could almost hear her silent moan and see the way her chest heaved with each ragged breath. Her naked body was on full display, perky tits capped with hard, aching nipples, just begging to be sucked and teased. Directly above Faye's spread thighs, a dark hand gripped her tiny waist possessively, holding her firmly in place as he pounded up into her smooth and wet sex. The man's muscular arms were flexed, mid thrust, his magnificent cock at the center of it all. Thick and hard, stretching her pink pussy wide open, claiming her completely.

"Wow," Cassandra murmured, her own breath shallow. Marshall hadn't let her come earlier, and she was way out over her edge now. She couldn't keep her eyes off of the scene, nor could she keep her palm from running down along Austin's thigh. He had nice thighs, strong and muscular—she didn't remember that from their time together, back when they were so young, barely out of college. His muscles tensed at her touch, but he made no effort to remove her hand. "Is there more?"

She was close enough that she could hear Austin's gulp. He nodded. His thumb shook as he swiped to the next photo.

Like the first pic, the second must have been taken from the man's perspective. This time, they'd shifted. She was bent over the bed, doggy style, her round ass raised high in invitation. It was red with hand prints. Cassandra shivered, squeezing her thighs together. She loved being spanked. She loved rough sex.

She couldn't help but compare herself to Austin's wife. Faye's butt was smaller, pert and toned like a model's. Did he prefer that to Cassandra's bubble butt?

From this angle and the overexposure of the camera's flash, the man's dark skin provides a striking contrast against Faye's pale flesh. A strong hand gripped her tightly, fingers digging into her soft curves as he drove himself balls deep into her sopping wet cunt.

Cassandra trailed her nails up Austin's inner thigh as she shifted and squeezed her thighs even tighter. The booth suddenly suffocating, but in a good way, like a man's hands around her neck as he fucked her hard.

Austin swiped one more time.

“Oh, fuck,” Cassandra gasped.

A mirror selfie this time, the two lovers caught mid-fuck, Faye’s phone held before her to capture their reflection in a full-length mirror. She was riding her black lover reverse cowgirl, her back arched gracefully as she grinded back into his thick shaft. Her short, blonde hair, even more damp now, partially obscuring her face yet still revealing the raw ecstasy etched across her features.

Cassandra’s hand traveled higher, grazing Austin’s cock, which bulged hard and ready. What was she doing? This was dangerous, but she couldn’t stop herself. And she couldn’t stop staring at that photo, putting herself in Faye’s place.

The man that Faye had found was all man—a light-skinned black stud with chiseled abs that she could imagine must have rippled with each hard thrust forward. They glistened now, flexed and rigid. He had large hands, gripping Faye’s hips, and thick, muscular biceps.

And yet when Cassandra imagined herself in Faye’s place, it was not a big black cock she saw ravaging her, but the very man Faye herself had just cuckolded. The realization washed over like a big, crashing wave. It was Austin that she wanted.

A message slid into view over the photo. A reminder that Austin was, in fact, off-limits.

[Faye]: Come back. I need you to reclaim me.

That seemed to snap Austin out of his spell, too. He finally shifted away from her, his beautiful, hard cock sliding from her grasp. And with it, the guilt came home. “I’m sorry,” she said. “I shouldn’t have—”

“Don’t apologize.” He shifted in his seat, and Cassandra wondered whether he was fighting back from the edge of his own orgasm. “I... I should go, though.”

Cassandra nodded. “And I should probably find my...”

They nodded together. Before he could slip away, though, Cassandra reached out and stopped him, a hand on his arm. “It was nice seeing you, Austin. I’ll... I’ll see you around. We’ve got what? Seven more days?”

He smiled back, and it felt so good to receive that. “See you around, Cass.”

Cassandra sank into the booth once Austin was gone, tipped her head back and sighed. That was unexpected, but not in a bad way. Her heart was still singing along when Marshall joined her, grinning with expectation.

“You look satisfied,” he said, moving right up beside her. “He take care of you?”

Oh. Marshall thought that she’d fucked Austin. That was... interesting. “Yeah, he took care of me.”

It wasn’t a lie, even if it wasn’t exactly the whole truth. For the first time in years, Cassandra felt a spark with someone. She’d had plenty of lovers, many of them very skilled, but those always felt like performances for Marshall’s benefit. Even though nothing had actually happened with Austin, she felt like she’d done it for herself.

“Come on, let’s go back to the room. Time for *me* to remind you who you’re married to.”

“Yes, please.” She could use the reminder.

Austin left the Nautical Nook Bar in a daze. He could still feel Cassandra's touch. He could still smell her perfume, still see the bountiful cleavage afforded by her dress. Most of all, though, her smile, her eyes, and her laughter lingered.

Mixed in with all of that good stuff, though, was guilt. Maybe in another world, under other circumstances, feeling guilty because a woman ran her hand up his leg would have been silly when his partner was getting railed at the same time, but this wasn't another world. Fair or not, he'd entered an agreement with his wife—she got to fuck, he got to watch.

"Or sometimes watch," he said to himself as he exited the bar.

On his way back to the room, though, he had to wonder what it might have been like to be married to someone more like Cassandra. He didn't get the feeling that his ex would shut him out and edge him so hard.

"There you are," Faye said when he finally made it back to the room. She wasn't accusatory. Her tone wasn't biting. It was more like she'd misplaced her keys and had finally found them.

"Sorry, these corridors, they all look the same." He shut the door behind him. "Looked like you had some fun."

She was naked in bed, the covers draped over her without actually covering much. She sighed, relaxing into the pillows and stretching her arms above her head. "It was a good way to start this trip."

"You know what would make it better?" He started to unbutton his shirt.

“What did you have in mind?” She fixed him with a coy look, her eyes darting over his chest as he pulled his shirt off.

“My turn to play?” He hated how his voice turned the statement into a question at the very end of that statement. Force of habit.

“I don’t know, honey. Joe wore me out.”

Austin pushed his slacks off, his cock springing free. “I think you have a little bit more left in you.”

Faye lifted her brows, a smile playing across her face at the same time. “Mmm, Austin, getting a little feisty.”

“I’m just here to remind you who you married.” He climbed onto the bed and kissed his wife.

She tasted... astringent. She tasted like another man’s come. Austin pulled away, but Faye held him to her long enough to banish any doubt.

When he pulled free of her grasp, she moved her hands down between his legs, where he was rock hard. “I swallowed his load before he left,” she said. Well, most of it, anyway. You like the taste?”

“Faye...”

“Your cock says you like it.”

“*Faye.*” There was a growl behind his voice this time. They both heard it. They were both surprised by it.

“Ooo,” she started, before Austin’s lips crashed back into hers again. He felt her gasp as he seized control, rolling her onto her back, his body pressing down around her. “Oh, Austin!”

He sank into her, turned on even more by how loose she felt, how absolutely wet she was. It had been too long since he’d had his dick in her—in his own wife. A primal growl tore through him as he sank all the way in.

“Yes, baby, fuck me! Unnngh, fuck!” Her nails dug into his back as his hips rose and fell, taking back what was his. “Fuck me where Joe just fucked me. Where another man put his first load.”

“Oh, fuck!” Austin barked. He almost lost it. It was a total sneak attack, but no, he wouldn’t give Faye the satisfaction of coming just then. He weathered it, channeling some other man from some other life—Cassandra’s husband, maybe, master of his own domain, master of his own wife.

“Is this what you want?” he rasped, setting a punishing rhythm that left her gasping for breath. “To be fucked like some cheap slut?” He grunted,

each word punctuated by a forceful thrust of his hips. “To be used?”

This was nothing like their usual lovemaking, and definitely nothing like Austin’s usual self. There was no tenderness, and certainly no passive submission. This was raw, primal, fueled by frustration.

And yet Faye seemed to love it. “Oh, Austin, fuck me!” She wrapped her legs around his waist, drawing him deeper with each powerful stroke. “Oh God, yes... Harder, Austin. Fuck me harder!”

Her order only enraged him more. He upped his tempo, becoming frantic. Their bodies collided with bruising force, the sound of skin slapping against skin echoing through his mind.

Only it wasn’t Joe that he was competing with. It wasn’t even a competition that involved his wife at all. At that moment, he wondered if this was how Cassandra’s husband reclaimed her. Whether it was happening right now, off in another cabin, with his ex-girlfriend on her back as her husband railed away.

Austin’s climax arrived at last—all his muscles screaming, convulsing, clenching as he buried his face in the crook of Faye’s soft neck and exploded. It was a torrent, weeks of pent up frustration. Yet underlying it all, the thought of Cassandra receiving her own reclamation burned along his skin and itched across his scalp, refusing to be banished by thoughts of Faye.

Once he finished he rolled off his wife and crashed. Hard. The drinks, the cuckolding, the stolen flirtations in that nook, all came racing up to bury him beneath a tidal wave of confusing reality.

Faye was there when the red finally cleared. “Well that was...”

Austin held his breath, ready for her to say something deflating. She surprised him.

“...fucking impressive.” She ran her fingers through her damp locks. “Where did that come from?”

“Just... this cruise. I guess.”

“Well,” she said, staring at him like she was seeing him for the first time. Or maybe she was just remembering the man she’d first met all those years before. “I liked it. And to think, this is just day one!”

Cassandra regretted her shoes after the first half hour ashore. The cork-heeled Jimmy Choo sandals, even with their more modest heel, were not ideal for walking through the streets of downtown Nassau.

Still, it was good to be on solid ground, the sun bright in a cloudless blue sky. The weather was perfect, just touching the 80s, with a salty breeze coming off of the ocean and rustling through the palm trees lining the boulevard. So much nicer than the slushy weather of the Pacific Northwest in January.

All around them, vendors hawked their wares—vibrant bolts of fabric, intricate wood carvings, artwork made of polished sea shells and paint. Cassandra took it all in, breathing deeply and savoring the mingled scents of saltwater, spices, and suntan lotion that perfumed the air. She loved to travel, to experience new things, to immerse herself in local culture.

Marshall was less into it than she was, although he seemed surprisingly patient as they browsed the market. She realized why a moment later, as he paused and said, “Ah, now here we go.”

She followed his gaze to a small storefront of scandalously skimpy swimsuits and sarongs. Each eye-catching ensemble looks tailor-made to leave absolutely nothing to the imagination.

“I see,” she said as he flashed her a toothy grin. “And here I was, thinking you were looking for a new cutting board.”

He wandered over to the shop. “That really sound like me?”

“Good point.”

“I’ll buy you one.” He paused, running a fingertip over the silky material of a minuscule vibrant, pink bikini.

“How generous of you.”

“It’s why you married me.” He picked the pink bikini off the rack. “For my generosity.”

Cassandra laughed. “A real philanthropist.”

“I support a number of charities.” He plucked another suit off, a metallic gold monokini that would cover almost nothing.

“I know, dear. I wrote the checks.”

“Try these on,” he said, adding a third suit to the mix. “Model them for me like a good girl.”

“Honey, I don’t know. These are pretty out there.”

“Have you seen some of the suits aboard the ship? When in Rome...”

She took the suits from him and said, “That’s true. All of my suit bottoms had backs.”

“A genuine tragedy,” Marshall said, nodding.

Cassandra rolled her eyes with a laugh, then disappeared behind the small screen that made for a changing room. Wiggling out of her sundress and bra, she put the pink thong bikini on over her actual thong. Even still, it was shockingly revealing, cut high over her hip bones, the top barely containing her large breasts.

Emerging self-consciously, she struck a pose for Marshall. A few others passing along the street grinned and nodded. One tourist woman, carrying a solo cup and already looking flushed, shouted, “You go, girl!”

Marshall frowned at her underwear. “I can’t try on the suit without it,” she said.

“Then we’ll buy it. And the other two. But wear that one out along with...” He selected a white fishnet coverup that wouldn’t do much covering up. “...this.”

He did this. He had this habit of making her feel like an erotic plaything. Truth be told, she didn’t always mind it. There was a thrill in surrendering control, allowing herself to become the living embodiment of her husband’s deepest, darkest fantasies. But she wasn’t feeling it then. She was feeling... reduced.

She changed into the bikini and “coverup” anyway as Marshall paid the shop owner, stashing her clothing in her bag. He seemed to know that he’d

pushed things too far, though, stepping up to her and brushing her cheek with his thumb. “Relax, baby doll,” he said. “We don’t know anyone here. You can be whoever you want.”

“You mean I can be whoever *you* want.”

He threaded his fingers into hers and led her back onto the street. She fought back that exposed sensation. Plenty of women were walking around in bikinis, some just as small as hers.

“Don’t you always say that what I want, you want?” he asked.

“You’re being an ass, dear,” she said. But her anger was short-lived. He was mostly right—they didn’t know anyone here.

Well, except for Austin...

AUSTIN AND FAYE had lunch at a small sidewalk cafe in Nassau. “God, I can’t get over this weather,” Faye said. “No clouds!”

“So different from our honeymoon.” A server came by with a small round cake covered in chocolate, plus a couple of spoons. “All that rain.”

“Belize in September probably wasn’t the best idea.”

“Yeah, probably should have researched that one better,” he admitted. “This is nice though.”

Faye’s eyes wandered out over the people strolling through the quaint streets. Despite it being January, a season Austin equated with gray and gloom, the atmosphere here was like Carnival.

She made eye contact with a Latino man strolling by, shirtless, holding the hand of a stunning redhead. He winked at her and was gone. “Definitely nice,” she said, glancing back at Austin. “This still feels surreal.”

She was clearly no longer talking about the paradise around them, but of the cruise, the lifestyle, the sex. Which was fair. It wasn’t far from his mind, either.

“So last night was fun?” He was torn between wanting to know and fearing that she’d torment him more. Or maybe he was hoping that she would.

Faye turned her attention back to him, like a cat remembering that she was in the presence of a mouse. Austin shifted, his chest preemptively

tightening. “You know the answer to that, but yes. So much fun.”

Austin licked his lips nervously. “Was he...” Large? Austin squirmed, hating that it was the first question to come to mind. “...married? He’s here on this cruise. I guess I’m just not sure how this all works.”

The way Faye was smiling at him, she knew exactly what he really wanted to know. Mercifully, she didn’t taunt him with it. She shook her head. “He’s not. Apparently he’s on the ship for our pleasure.”

Austin thought of the man, his smugness, his complete dismissiveness. “Like a male prostitute?”

“Not exactly. I’m pretty sure he’s not paid, although I wouldn’t be surprised if his cabin was comped. And there are others, all with big... aspirations.”

“Interesting.”

“Not the word I’d use,” she said with a light laugh. “Exciting, maybe? But you’re also not wrong.”

“Are you... are you going to see him again?”

“What answer are you hoping for, dear?”

“I... I don’t think you should... limit yourself. Not with all your... options.”

Faye tossed her head back as she laughed. “Did he make you uncomfortable, Austin?”

“I just don’t...” Want to be humiliated? “...want to be left out.”

“Okay. Tonight then, I’ll make sure you get a front row seat.” Judging by how she was staring at him, he wasn’t sure if that was a good thing.

“What *is* the plan for tonight?”

“There’s a rave.”

“Right. Are we... you want to go to that? I’ve never...”

“Oh, yes, dear. It’ll be fun. Don’t you want to see your sexy wife get all dolled up and sweaty as she dances with some hot guys?”

Austin’s pants tightened. “Put like that... sounds fun.”

The bill arrived. Faye paid, and as she signed the check, she said, “I think I’m going to go lay out on the beach. Join me?”

At that moment, *she* passed And while the white fishnet coverup did nothing to actually merit its name, it was *her*, currently on the arm of an older man, who drew Austin further in. She was laughing at something her escort said, her lush, golden hair bouncing. Cassandra. Austin’s heart literally throbbed, and even he groaned at the cliché.

Mercifully, Cassandra didn't see him. He wondered if the man was her husband, or one of the studs brought on by the cruise. Either way, he felt the burn of jealousy that was normally reserved for his wife.

Faye noticed him checking Cassandra out, but of course she had no idea of the connection.

"Plenty more of that on the beach," she said.

He didn't want to lay in the sand when he could explore this paradise of a town. He wished they'd gone on an excursion somewhere, seen more of the island. But he also knew that the beach would be safe. No chance of running into Cass again.

"Sure, let's do the beach."

Cassandra could hear the party long before she saw it. She could feel the thump of the music along the deck. She could smell the ozone, the drinks, the energy.

“Excited, babydoll?” Marshall ran his thumb along Cassandra’s spine as they approached the cruise ship’s ballroom-turned-club.

She met his eyes and smiled. “Yes.” And she was. For maybe the first time since they’d come aboard, she was genuinely excited.

“Only took about a day-and-a-half?”

“Not true. It’s been fun. Nassau was beautiful.”

The white lie couldn’t fool Marshall. She never could. “Relax, Cassie. Embrace the moment. You can have *anyone*. You *will* have anyone. No strings here.”

Maybe it took walking around in public in basically a thong, but she’d dropped any lingering inhibitions from home. He was right. Here, hedonism reigned.

Nothing reinforced that point more than stepping into the club, awash in black light and the relentless beat of electropop. Cassandra’s hips fell into the driving rhythm, her shoulders starting to rock and swing. In the dark, under those lights, Cassandra’s white outfit started to glow—the bandeau top that left her midriff bare, the short, white skirt, the straps of her sandals that coiled up her calves.

In fact, she *was* the outfit, the rest of her body fading into the murk. It was like that with everyone—only the glowing bits of them moved and shifted, women in luminescent bikinis, shirtless men adorned in neon paint. It was *Día de los Muertos* meets orgy. It was a fever dream.

A woman with green and pink face paint spun by them, running her fingers across Cassandra's face. Her partner, a man with a shaved head and a bright, blue stripe of paint down the center, said something that Cassandra didn't hear, but she had the feeling it was something dirty.

"This is insane," she said to Marshall. Her husband shook his head, leaning close and shouting back, "What?"

"Nevermind. Let's dance!"

He shook his head, pointing to the bar and miming that he was getting a drink. She nodded, following him over to the bar, where a sexy bartender with her face painted to look like she was wearing a mask fixed them up a couple of cocktails that glowed blue under the lights.

"Want a little something extra?" she asked as she handed them their drinks.

"Extra?" Cassandra asked, confused.

The bartender flashed a clear vial of something she was holding in her hand, there and gone so fast that Cassandra wasn't sure she'd imagined it. "Molly."

"Oh, no thank you," she said quickly, flustered by such an overt offer.

"That could be fun," Marshall said.

She glanced at him, her heart skipping. "Nope, not a good idea." He looked ready to challenge her, to push her. He was forever pushing her. She stepped close, fingering his white shirt, which, like all the white in the place, was alight. "We don't need that to have a good time, and trust me, honey, I want to remember tonight."

It worked. He nodded, running his hands along her body. "I bet you do."

The music dropped to a lull as the DJ came on. "The body paint booth is now open, ladies and gentlemen. Get over there and show off your creativity! We have artists to help. There will be prizes for the best design!"

"I'm going to leave you here," he said. "But I'll be watching. Find someone who'll make tonight... memorable."

He kissed her passionately, spanked her ass, and disappeared into the crowd. Cassandra took a deep breath, lifted her glowy drink, and drank half of it.

“Okay,” she said, looking around. “Let’s do this.”

AUSTIN WATCHED Faye bump and grind on a young, fit guy wearing a tank top that glowed yellow. He had bands of alternating paint, orange and yellow, lacing his muscular arms, and wore a pair of ridiculous sunglasses that were also designed to light up.

There’d been a time when watching Faye lose herself in another man had felt like such a rush. The first time that she’d fucked someone else in front of him was still one of the most intense things he’d ever seen.

But as with any form of drug, Austin eventually developed a tolerance to it. So each time she did it, that tolerance only grew stronger. Lately, it seemed like she was doing it all the time.

Austin went to take a sip of his drink, only to realize that nothing but ice remained in his clear plastic cup. He gave Faye and her new man one last look before pushing into the crowd, heading for the bar.

This place was going nuts. They’d been here an hour already, and during that time, what had started as a charged rave had started to trend closer to an orgy. Faye and her dance partner were tame compared to what he was seeing. Half of the women seemed to be topless. People were making out all over the place.

As he passed by a set of couches in the chillout space, he watched as a guy with a shaved head went down on a brunette with flames painted all over her naked body, while a busty blonde sucked on her nipples.

“Jesus,” he groaned at the spectacle. A semi-circle of guys had gathered around the sofa, watching as the brunette arched her back and came hard. It wasn’t sex, but that would come next.

He started back toward the bar when the sight of Cassandra brought him up short again. Fate kept putting her in his path, and every time it did, his nerves thrummed and he felt light-headed. Guilt wasn’t far behind. He was married, and Cassandra was his past. It shouldn’t feel this good.

Now more than ever, because she wasn’t alone. She was leaning against the bar as a large man who looked like Thor hit on her.

God, she looked good. Unlike so many of the women here, trying so hard to fit into this party scene and failing, Cassandra seemed effortless.

She wasn't wearing any body paint. She didn't have silly glasses or glow necklaces or any of it. She was just Cassandra, wearing a sexy white top and skirt, which counted as borderline vanilla here.

Thor leaned down, running his hand through his thick, golden locks, and said something to her that made her giggle and blush. Biting her lip, she nodded. He slid his hand into hers and pulled her along as she searched the crowd—searched for her husband.

Instead of finding him, her eyes landed on Austin's. It felt like someone had stepped on his chest. Like that, the air was out of his lungs. *This is what it used to feel like with Faye*, he thought. Or so he was pretty sure.

Her eyes went as wide as his. Her lips parted, and when she glanced at her large companion, she looked embarrassed. Austin tried to force his expression into something like a reassuring smile, but it probably came out like a man ready to be sick. That's how he felt, anyway.

Yet at the same exact time, he was so fucking turned on. So much so that he almost forgot what the hell he was doing there until he found himself at the bar again, ordering another drink. He did that on autopilot, anxious to get back to the dance floor.

He did not remember the bartender asking about extras—which she had. He didn't remember watching her stir something clear into his drink—which he also had. And he certainly didn't remember finishing most of it before he even made it back to the sea of dancing humanity.

At some point, though, as he searched for Faye... or Cassandra... the whole world began to bounce. For a second, he thought that the ship had hit some large waves, and yet he couldn't stop smiling. Someone moved past him, a topless Asian woman holding glow sticks. Her lips were coated in something that made them catch the light, and when she smiled, he smiled.

"You're cute," she said as she passed.

"So are you!" he found himself saying. She *was* cute, and she deserved to hear that from him.

The room continued to bounce and roll, like the ocean was in the room, surging and swelling along the floor. Hands were in the air. Lights streaked across his vision—lights that felt fucking *good*.

"What the fuck is happening?" he said aloud as he stared at his hands and laughed. He had nice hands, and they felt good on his face.

People swirled around him as he lost himself in the chaos of the dance floor. And he danced, moving his body without the inhibitions that he'd

built up over the years. He didn't care who stared. He didn't care if he looked ridiculous. Not anymore. He just did what felt good.

And what felt good was the smoking hot brunette with South Asian features and a tight body who pressed herself against him.

"You look like you're having fun!" she shouted into his ear. Her breath smelled like mint and vodka, and her lips looked amazing, like perfectly sculpted bows.

"You have nice lips," he said, the words tumbling out.

"I do like them," she said with a delighted laugh. "Want to kiss them?"

"Can I?"

She just laughed again and pulled him in for a deep, surprisingly soft kiss. Her tongue was warm and wet, playful, alluring. When he felt her hand run up between his legs, he shivered.

"I should go. I'm married."

"So am I," she yelled back. "That's kind of the point of this cruise."

Austin just laughed, moving on, dancing with random people as he floated about, searching for...

"Cass." He mouthed the words like he was sharing a secret with the yawning cosmos. She didn't hear him, of course. She didn't even see him, but he saw her, and the love and affection he had for her was profound.

"See that blonde?" he said to the guy who happened to be dancing next to him. "I *love* her."

"Right on, man. She's fucking hot!"

"I know, right?"

She wasn't alone. She was now *dancing* with the Thor guy, her back to the faux thunder god, her ass pressed against his pelvis as he ran his hands up over her tits. Maybe it was the lighting, or maybe it was whatever chemical high that he finally realized that he was on, but she glowed. And it was more than just the black lights and the white clothing and the platinum hair. She was his angel.

And she was having fun, so *he* was having fun.

"There you are, Austin!"

"Faye!" Austin crowed. "I've missed you sooo much, honey!" And with that, he threw his arms around his wife and squeezed her tight.

Faye pulled back, eyeing him, immediately suspicious. "You on something?"

He shrugged, then started to smile. "Pretty sure I am, but I have no idea. Aw, why do you look like that, babe. I'm doing great."

She snorted a laugh. "I bet you are."

A man draped his arm around Faye's shoulders. He was bare-chested with tattoos up and down one arm and across his shoulder. He'd also painted his nipples hot pink and had scrawled "Stunt Cock" on his abs. "This the husband?" he asked.

Before Faye could respond, Austin gave the man a broad smile and held out his hand. "Oh, hello there. You look like my wife's type!"

"Yes, this is Austin, who appears to have been roofied."

"Not roofied. But I think the bartender gave me something stronger than alcohol." He couldn't stop smiling, and he felt good everywhere.

The man just looked amused at the whole thing. Faye, on the other hand, continued to look put out, and that made Austin sad for her. "Oh, don't let this ruin your night, honey. Go on, take 'stunt cock' here back to our room."

"I like this man," Stunt Cock said.

Faye sighed. "I can't leave him like this."

"Oh, he'll be fine," the guy said. "Plenty of people around here are rolling like crazy."

"I'm sure, but only this one is my husband, and I can't trust him after just a few drinks. No telling what this'll do."

Austin looked perplexed, their conversation sinking slowly through the fog of Molly and vodka. "Don't worry about me, babe! I'll be fine, and everyone's having such a good time..."

"See?" the guy said. "He's all good. Now come on, let's make the time even better."

Austin was so happy for Faye as he watched the guy guide her off the dance floor. He kept dancing, lost in the music and the bodies all around him. Every brush against another person felt like magic. Every smile he shared was like meeting his soulmate for the first time.

"Hi." "Hello." "You're so beautiful." "You're such a good dancer."

Everyone was friendly. Everyone was there with him, living their best life, living this moment.

Cassandra materialized out of the crowd, strobe lights catching in her hair. It was the fog, the smoke, the psychedelic lighting, but he swore he saw angel wings rising up around her. "Cass," he sighed.

This time, she heard him. This time, she *saw* him. Thor was gone, and she had a look of concern etched across her beautiful face.

“Are you okay, Austin?”

“I’m *so* okay.” He stepped up close to her, slipping his hands over her hips. Her skin felt so soft. How was her skin so soft? “I’ve never been more okay.”

She cocked her head, studying him. “Let me guess, you got something ‘extra’ from the bar?”

“I did!”

She got it. She always got it, he thought. Or maybe he was speaking. It was hard to tell where his thoughts ended and his mouth began. “You always got me, Cass. Why did we ever break up?”

He felt her fingers entwine with his, and that felt amazing, too. He squeezed her hand, which seemed to fit so perfectly in his. “I love you, Cassandra. Like, I’ve always, always loved you.”

She looked at him with an expression that he couldn’t decipher through his drug-induced haze. “Come on, let’s get you some water, and somewhere quieter.”

“You don’t want to dance? I love to dance.”

Cassandra laughed. “Now I *know* you’re on something. Unless you’ve *really* changed. Come along, my love. Just... trust me.”

And he did. He always had. He always would.

“Drink this.” Cassandra unscrewed the top of the water bottle and shoved it into Austin’s hand. “You’re going to be really thirsty soon.”

“You are so amazing, Cass.” The way he beamed at her was adorable, but she saw the telltale signs of the drug in him—the blown out pupils and the way he just couldn’t sit still.

“Is your wife here?”

“No, she left,” he said, like it was the most delightful thing in the world. “With some guy. I’m so happy for her. She’s going to get fucked so hard.”

It was the drug talking, she knew, but Cassandra also heard how genuine the sentiment was. He really did love what his wife was doing—and not because *he* wanted it, but because *she* did. But she also shouldn’t have left him alone in this state.

“Come on, let’s get you out of here.”

“What?” he shouted back.

“Somewhere quieter,” she said. She turned, glancing back into the pulsing, sweaty mass of bodies on the dance floor, the throbbing bass vibrating in her bones. “Not here.”

Austin was fixated on the neon lights strobing hypnotically overhead, painting the writhing crowd in lurid splashes of color. It was utter chaos, a sea of grinding hips and groping hands, yet somehow, the bodies on the dance floor parted like a curtain being pulled back, and she saw Marshall

standing there, watching her, drink in hand and that familiar, intense expression on his face.

Her husband was expecting her to perform. She *wanted* to perform. But right in that moment, this was more important to her. Tugging Austin along, she ignored Marshall and shouted back at him, "Come on!"

"Where are we going?" Austin's question seemed to arise out of curiosity, not suspicion. She could have pushed him overboard and he probably would have gone along with it, laughing all the way.

"I don't actually know," she said with a giggle, guiding him through the dimly lit corridors of the ship.

"An adventure!" he said cheerily. "I always loved our adventures."

She didn't respond, but she *was* touched. They emerged out onto one of the decks. Couples were out here, snuggling in the shadows. It was intimate, despite the open air. Romantic. She wasn't sure if that was what she was going for.

They climbed a set of stairs, up onto yet another deck. There, on one of the loungers, a woman was riding a man hard, her bikini discarded. They didn't notice Cassandra or Austin. Austin's eyes went wide at the sight.

"They're so beautiful," he whispered to her as she guided him away, down along the side of the ship. The ocean sloshed far below. Moonlight glinted off the water.

"Here we go," she said, finding a completely unoccupied pool tucked away on a smaller deck in the midsection.

"Whoa," Austin breathed, gazing around in wonder at the star-speckled sky above. "It's so beautiful out here. Like something out of a dream..."

Cassandra pulled him over to a secluded alcove shielded from view by a copse of potted palms. "Let's sit here for a minute. Enjoy the night, and drink your water."

Austin nodded. He'd already finished one bottle, so she handed him the second. "I love this," he said. He reached out and touched the silver belly bar that pierced her navel. Tonight, she wore a simple one, capped with clear crystals to catch in the black lights.

Cassandra gasped, her tummy tightening where his fingers lightly grazed her skin. "Thanks."

"You didn't have this when we were together."

"No." She held her breath, waiting for him to judge her for all the changes that she'd made. It didn't come.

“I like it. Suits you.”

“How are you feeling?” she asked.

“Amazing.” He didn’t take his hand off of her, and she didn’t remove it, either. It wasn’t sexual, that touch, but it also wasn’t platonic, either. She sidled closer to him, letting him trace circles around her belly button. “I feel so... connected. To everything. It’s...”

“Amazing?” she finished. They shared a laugh. God, that felt good. “Keep drinking. I’ll go get you another bottle.”

“Do you have to go?”

“I’m just going over there.” She pointed to a water cooler standing out on deck not ten feet away. “Not far.”

Reluctantly, she slipped out of his embrace. He didn’t try to stop her. Instead, he slumped into the plush lounge chair, one arm over his head, and watched her go.

“You know I used to watch you? Like, all the time?”

“Hm?” She glanced back at him as she filled one of the empty plastic bottles.

“I never told you, but... back when you worked at the vet’s, my office was across the street, second floor. I used to look out the window and see you sitting there, always with a smile, like an angel. And I just knew that you were this *amazing* person. I wanted to get to know you.”

He’d never told her that story. They’d met when he brought his cat in after she’d swallowed a bunch of yarn. She remembered how scared he looked, and how she wanted to comfort him.

“So you stalked me before asking me out?” she teased, returning to his side. She cuddled up with him, like they were still together and were getting settled for an evening movie.

“I can see how you could get there,” he acknowledged. “But it wasn’t like that. I just liked how you treated every person who came in there with such empathy. All these people, so concerned about their pets, and I could just tell that they felt better after talking to you.” He stroked her arm. “God, your skin is so soft.”

“You’re still on the E,” she giggled.

“I don’t think I ever want it to stop. This is amazing!”

“We are on a pleasure cruise sailing through the tropics. You know you don’t need drugs to feel amazing, right?”

“You’re right. You’re so smart, Cass.”

It wasn't something she was used to hearing that often. Most people just saw the blonde hair and big boobs and drew a different conclusion.

He kept going. "You were the best thing to ever happen to me. You're caring, funny, hot as hell, and I loved you. I still do."

That was the Molly taking, Cassandra knew, but it still hit her like a jolt. So did his touch, his closeness, his body. If she wasn't careful, she'd take advantage of this drugged man—which she absolutely wasn't going to do.

"Come on, want to feel something really amazing?" She stood and held her hands out to him.

Austin stood a little too abruptly and their faces came within inches of each other. She watched his gaze dip down to her lips before meeting her eyes again. She fought back the urge to take his hands and place them on her hips.

"Come on, I'm pretty sure that there's a hot tub up there."

Set apart from the pool and up on a short dais was the smaller hot tub, tendrils of wispy steam rising from the swirling eddies of the warm water.

"What about suits?" Austin asked.

"Come on, just get in. It'll feel great." After untying her sandals, she stepped in, still wearing her white skirt and top, which quickly became completely transparent.

Austin shrugged and joined her "You may want to...", she began, but when he didn't even bother to take off his shoes, she just shrugged. "Or just get in."

"Oh, fuck, that feels like... wow that gets amazing—OH! There are jets!"

Cassandra giggled again, watching Austin ride out the tail end of his high. She'd tried that before. Marshall had gone through a phase just after the IPO, back when they were newly wealthy, when every experience was new. Marshall had led, Cassandra had followed—Ecstasy, gummies, 'shrooms... coke. She could still remember Marshall calling her into the backroom of a party that they were attending, thinking he just wanted to hook up in public, only to find him and a couple other guys doing lines off of a mirror. *'Cassie, try this.'*

Cassandra shook her head, clearing the shame of that memory. She wasn't high now, and the effects of her one drink were long gone, but it was almost like she was feeling Austin's secondary effects—his unguarded laughter made *her* laugh, his infectious grin made *her* want to smile in a

way that she hadn't smiled in a long time. She could almost share the pleasure vibrating through his body as she sank beneath the hot water and pressed her aching muscles against the jets.

He reached out, taking her hand and pulling her close. She surrendered to his tug, just as she'd let him touch her belly button ring before. This felt... right.

"You know, I remember you before we got together, too?" she said.

"You're talking about Misty?" Misty, the cat.

"No, before that. You used to go to that corner cafe and read during lunch. You were so lost in your book, whatever it was, and I *always* wondered what you were reading, but could never get the nerve up to ask."

"No way. You?"

"Me," she giggled. "I always thought you were cute."

"That's so crazy. I remember when you came in, too. You know what I was reading?"

She shook her head.

"I don't, either." He laughed. "Every time you walked in, my mind went blank. I'd reread the same page over and over, willing myself not to stare at you. After all, you *were* the girl I stared at through the window."

Cassandra joined him in laughter. Somehow, she'd found herself in his lap in the hot tub, half turned to him, his arms wrapped around her waist beneath the bubbling froth. She could feel his dick pressed against her, hard and so tempting. So ready. She was also suddenly keenly aware of her breast on his chest, just two thin layers of wet fabric separating them. She hadn't worn a bra, and they both noticed her nipples clearly visible through her now-translucent white top.

She remembered the way they used to kiss. She remembered the way he used to look up at her as he went down on her. She wanted that again, and why not? As she'd told Austin, this was a cruise full of hotwives and swingers.

"Austin?"

"Hmm?"

And she kissed him—gently at first, like the prelude to something greater, the opening notes of an orchestra as the lights dimmed. His lips on hers were somehow both brand new and familiar. His beard was different, but his taste was not.

She curled her hand around the back of his neck, where his tapered hair was so impossibly soft. The kiss deepened. He met her passion with his own, like a spreading fire on the way to growing out of control.

His hand rested on her hip beneath the water. She sidled closer, half turning into him, pressing herself to him.

When the kiss broke, they stared at one another, bewildered, flustered, but without regret. He was smiling at her, and for the first time that night, she didn't think the smile was mostly chemically induced.

"Don't you two look cute!" The female voice filtered into their private world, breaking the moment. Right, they weren't alone, and were, in fact, in a public space.

"Sorry to interrupt," a man said. "We didn't think that anyone else was up here."

"Well, hello!" Austin said, turning his exuberance on the newcomers. "You have suits. Good choice."

They were wearing swimsuits, although the woman's was smaller than even the ones that Marshall had bought her earlier that day. She had the body to pull it off, built like a model. With her glossy brown hair and large eyes, she could have been one at that.

"Hope you don't mind," she said, but she also didn't wait for a response before slipping into the hot tub. Her partner, a man slightly older than any of them, couldn't stop staring at Cassandra's tits.

Austin answered for the both of them. "Of course not! Please, join us. Right, Cass?"

"Of course," Cassandra said, although she felt a little disappointed that they weren't alone any longer.

"Don't let us interrupt anything," the guy said.

"We won't tell." The woman winked at them before straddling her partner's lap and kissing him passionately.

"Umm, okay," Cassandra said, because she didn't know what else to say.

"They're in love, too," Austin said. His hands started to travel up her body, and Cassandra didn't stop him. She also didn't dare to look back at him, though, afraid of what may happen. Instead, she kept her gaze fixed on the new couple as they made out.

The guy untied the brunette's bikini top, and she discarded it as he bent down and feasted on her small tits.

Cassandra gasped as Austin ran his hands up over her own tits. Involuntarily, she arched into his touch. He cupped her boobs, his fingers finding her hard nipples. “Oh...”

Her moan drew the attention of the other couple. The guy whispered something into the brunette’s ear, something that made her giggle and nod. A moment later, she waded the short distance over to Cassandra and Austin.

“He says you two shouldn’t be wearing clothes in the hot tub.” She stopped just before the two of them. “He says it’s against the rules.”

“Oh, so sorry,” Austin said. He started to rise when the other woman reached out and stopped him.

“You don’t have to go,” she purred. Her fingers drifted to the buttons of his shirt. “Here, let me help.”

“Oh,” Austin said as her fingers slid inside his shirt and along his skin. “That feels nice.”

The desire to smack this woman’s hand away was a visceral thing, like someone yanking on the short hairs on the back of her neck.

Then she felt the woman’s companion at her other side, drawing her up and out of Austin’s lap. “Your husband’s in good hands,” he said. “And you deserve your own set of hands.”

Overwhelmed, she looked to Austin, half-expecting to see him making out with this new harlot. But he wasn’t. Even as the brunette peeled open his wet shirt and toyed with the sexy copse of chest hair on his broad pecs, his eyes were locked on Cassandra, like she was all that mattered.

She was *seen*—not as an accessory or a doll or a toy, but for her own wants, her own desires, her own self.

When the man leaned in and kissed her neck, Austin’s breath caught. His eyes seemed to burn. Had his eyes always been so beautiful, like the ocean at its deepest point?

The man pulled her bandeau top down, freeing her tits, and even still, Austin’s eyes didn’t stray from hers. It was only when the guy’s head dropped lower, latching his mouth onto her nipples, that he finally checked out her naked chest.

This was accelerating. She knew where this was headed. She’d been here countless times before with Marshall, even sharing the random hookup with a nameless couple. But this felt different.

She was on fire. The restraint that she’d been propping up all night long finally buckled. She pulled the guy’s head up to hers and planted a deep kiss

right on his mouth. He tasted like cigarettes and whiskey—a heady combination because it was so new. She reached down between her legs, finding his bulge in his swim trunks.

He had a nice dick—a *new* dick. A dick that she could ride if she wanted, and she was starting to think about how much fun it could be to do that in front of Austin. He broke the kiss and nibbled on her ear. “Mmm, your hand feels so good.”

“Your wife is so fucking hot,” Cassandra heard the other woman say to Austin.

Your wife. It was a nice thought. A wistful one. And when Austin didn’t contradict her, just saying, “Yeah, she is,” Cassandra’s heart sang.

“Does she like other girls?”

“I actually don’t know,” Austin said with a laugh.

Cassandra looked over at the time, seeing Austin’s wide-eyed curiosity and the brunette’s hunger, and answered by reaching for her and drawing her in for a deep, girl-on-girl kiss. She preferred cock, but she wasn’t a stranger to pussy. Marshall loved a show. Seemed like Austin did, too.

She felt the men crowd around them, could feel the stranger’s cock driving into her ass cheek as she swapped spit with his lover. It had been a while since she’d kissed another woman and had forgotten about how fun it could be, how soft, how pliable, how good they smelled.

The woman slid her fingers into Cassandra’s thong, going right for her pussy. Cassandra gasped at the touch, breaking the kiss.

“Bald,” the woman said with a wicked smile. “You *are* a little Barbie Doll, aren’t you?”

“You should see me do the splits,” Cassandra said as the woman’s fingers curled into her pussy.

“Let’s take this back to our cabin.” The guy’s suggestion was directed at Austin, and again, Cassandra was reminded of how different he was from Marshall.

Cassandra and Austin locked eyes, and it was like they could clearly see how the rest of the night could play out. It would have been mind-blowingly hot, the perfect way to end an already deep beginning. But she also knew that he was still rolling, still out of it, and she couldn’t take advantage of that more than she already had. She hadn’t plucked him out of the club just to use him now.

“Maybe a rain check,” she said, giving the woman one last kiss. “It’s late and we need to get back.... you know....to *our* room.”

“Oh, that’s no fun,” the woman pouted. “This was just getting started.”

Cassandra reached for Austin’s hand, and was thrilled when he squeezed hers back. “I wouldn’t say that it just started,” she called over her shoulder before clasping her unoccupied hand around his bicep and leaning into him as *he* led *her* away. “You two have fun!”

O f all the wild things that had just happened, it was her kiss with Austin that lingered as Cassandra made her way back to her room. Her lips still tingled. She could still feel the soft, short hairs that tapered up the nape of his neck. She wanted to be back in that moment, warm, safe... *seen*.

But she was being silly. He probably didn't even remember the kiss, and definitely wouldn't in the morning. After the hot tub, she'd helped Austin find his room, leaving him with a lingering hug that was most likely the product of the party drugs, rather than any genuine affection.

She laughed to herself, ascending the couple of decks to her suite. It was a fun night, nothing more. So she told herself as she tried to wipe the smile from her face.

Marshall was waiting for her, sitting on the balcony in just his boxers, looking out at sea as he sipped on a whiskey. An open bottle sat beside him, half of it gone. Her euphoria was recast as guilt. She'd left him alone to have her fun. She'd abandoned him.

Setting her heels by the door, she crossed the room, pausing at the sliding glass that led out onto the balcony. "Hey," she said softly.

He shifted, his eyes scanning her wet clothes, her wet hair, and her guilt-ridden expression. "You look like you've had a night."

"You're upset."

"Little bit, yeah. I don't love being excluded."

Time to atone.

She sauntered out onto the balcony, crossing her arms to peel off her wet tube top. She heard the way his breath caught. "I'm sorry, baby. I just got caught up in the night." Her skirt went next, along with her thong. "How can I make it up to you?"

He lifted his glass and sipped, studying her naked body, cast in the ethereal glow of the moonlight. He shifted, spreading his thighs just slightly. It was as much a command as any—one that she first obeyed out of guilt, but by the time she was on her knees, she did it out of need.

"I kissed... strangers," she admitted, tracing Marshall's dick through his boxers. He was already hard.

"Strangers?" he asked, putting emphasis on the plural.

"Yes. I left with... this guy..."

"Oh, I saw." He brushed her chin with his hand.

"...and we ended up in some random hot tub together." She unzipped Marshall, fishing out his thickening cock. "And we weren't alone."

With her blue eyes never leaving Marshall's darker pupils, she wrapped her lips around his cock and swirled the tip with her tongue. He groaned. She sucked hard as she pulled off of him, her mouth leaving his dick with a loud pop.

"You know how much I like feeling multiple hands on my body," she said, stroking him to full length. "Or multiple mouths..."

None of it was a lie. Those things had happened, and Marshall chose to fill in the details himself. So did Cassandra. "He had a nice, hard dick," she teased, bending down to take her husband's hard dick back into her mouth. She bobbed along it, swirling and feeling it grow. "He liked when I touched it."

Marshall pushed his fingers into her damp hair, his groans growing. "And both guys liked it when I kissed the other woman," she said. "She was so hot. Tight body. Long fingers that felt so good inside my thong."

Cassandra sucked the tip of his cock back into her mouth, swirled it, then popped off again. "She called your wife a Barbie Doll. You like that?"

Marshall pushed her head back onto his dick. She obliged, encircling his veiny length as she began to bob and jack at once.

"You were at the center of the action, weren't you?" he said.

She nodded without taking her eyes or her mouth off of him.

“That’s my girl. That’s my good little slut.” He inhaled deeply, relishing her blowjob the way he would a fine glass of wine.

Cassandra slurped off of him, sitting up higher on her knees. She wrapped her enhanced tits around his cock, squeezing her cleavage around him with her hands.

“Fuck, that looks so good,” he groaned.

Looks, not feels. Marshall always was all about appearances.

“You like seeing my big titties wrapped around a hard dick?” she asked rhetorically.

“Fuck, yeah.”

“Then I’m sorry you missed tonight.” To her, it was a non-sequitur. To him, he heard what he needed to hear. He practically dragged her into his lap. “You’re so hard,” she whispered, guiding him into her. “Uh! That’s so good...”

“You’re wet,” Marshall grunted. “No condom?”

Cassandra didn’t answer, instead riding him harder and faster. She needed it. She needed his dick to remind her that she was married, to remind her what her boundaries were. She may not have had sex with Austin, but she still needed to feel reclaimed by Marshall.

Her lack of an answer inflamed her husband. He groped her ass, taking control as he bounced her in his lap. They didn’t have an agreement about protection, and they also knew all the careful screening that all guests needed to undertake before coming aboard. Even still, most in this lifestyle used condoms. Cassandra and Marshall did, too. The few times that she hadn’t had really pushed his buttons, though, and that evening, after the kiss, after the guilt, she needed all of his buttons pressed at once.

“Fuck me, baby,” she gasped. “Make me yours again.”

“You are *mine*,” he growled, driving hard, his fingers digging into her ass. “Mine, babydoll. All... fucking... mine!”

The next morning, Austin felt like all of the water had been sucked out of his face. He also had a wicked headache. It was also close to 11 and he was alone in his cabin.

“What the hell happened?”

He turned, sat up on the edge of the bed. Even that simple movement felt sluggish and slow. Everything was an effort.

Then he remembered the “something extra”—the Molly, his first ever experience with drugs.

And *then* he remembered all of this rest.

“Oh, fuck.” He buried his head in his hands as images flitted by. He remembered Cassandra, had a vague memory of telling her that he loved her, of confessing that thing where he watched her creepily from his office window, and...

The kiss.

He touched his lips. He remembered liking it, but maybe that was just the drugs. Why had he done that? And what the hell was he going to tell Faye? And where was she anyway?

He picked up his phone, but it was dead. It didn’t even turn on when he plugged it in, and he realized that he’d had it in his pants pocket when they’d gotten into the hot tub.

Oh, God, the hot tub. Wherever it seemed like he’d reached a low point in his embarrassment, he remembered another thing. There had been others

there last night. A woman that he'd also kissed right in front of Cassandra. So now he'd gone from betraying one woman to two.

And realizing that he'd potentially hurt Cassie somehow hit him harder.

Giving up on his phone, he twisted open a bottle of water, chugged half of it, and went in search of some Advil. His stomach grumbled. He was hungry... and needed a shower... and needed to find Faye. For a moment, he stood in the center of the room, overwhelmed and full of regrets that he couldn't even name.

Then he walked out onto his balcony, sat with the water, and watched the endless blue horizon. It should have felt freeing, open, vast. Instead, Austin just felt so insignificant in the grand scheme of things, moved by forces that he couldn't control, his fate already predetermined.

Somewhere in the back of his mind, Austin was aware that his thoughts had something to do with the come down from the MDMA, that he'd emptied his cup of euphoria last night, and was drained of it now. But that wasn't the only thing happening here. At the moment he was just too overwhelmed to figure it all out.

Eventually, though, he had to leave the room. He took a shower, which helped somewhat. Dressed in a pair of shorts and a Hawaiian shirt, he ventured out of the room. With his phone busted, he couldn't text Faye, so he went in search of her.

And immediately got lost.

He was hopeless with directions, and spent about fifteen minutes wandering the corridors before even making it out into daylight. It was a beautiful day—a day at sea, if he remembered, heading towards the Virgin Islands. All around him were couples doing normal, couple things. He could almost fool himself into thinking this was any other cruise.

Almost, anyway. The bikinis by the pools were smaller. There was still a sizzle in the way everyone looked at each other. Women walking by gave him a once over and a wink. A few even ran their hands across his broad shoulders.

Without a real destination, he just wandered—hoping to find Faye, worried that he'd run into Cassandra. He found something called the Explorer's Lounge, which felt like it was lifted out of Adventureland in Disney's Magic Kingdom. Except for the couple making out in one of the cozy nooks as another man watched from across their table.

But the place had food, and it was nearly lunchtime. And while he needed to find his wife, he needed to eat even more.

He was keenly aware that he was the only guy who was single in the whole lounge. Everyone was either coupled up or in a group. Some women were with their husbands, who almost universally seemed to cling to their wives, reveling in the connection. Others were with bulls, most of whom were fit, confident, and having the best time of their lives.

All of it made Austin's food taste like sawdust. He chewed and swallowed and wandered away, needing to find fresh air again.

He found the entrance to the spa, wondering if Faye may be in there. Not that he could go barging in. He did wait around at the entrance on the off-chance that she'd emerge. A flyer was hung on the bulletin board, announcing yoga classes held on the Horizon Dec, every morning at 7. That seemed optimistic for a cruise like this, but to each their own.

He finally tracked Faye down at the Mermaid Cove, the pool with the swim-up bar. Of course.

She was on a lounge, her top untied, as a man wearing a lifeguard's red Speedos rubbed sunscreen into her skin. With her sunglasses on, Austin wasn't even sure that she saw him as he approached.

Apparently she did, rising up onto her arms enough to flash the side of her breasts. "There you are," she said. Turning to the lifeguard, she said, "Thanks, Mike. My husband can finish now."

"I really don't mind," the bronzed and muscled lifeguard said. "I'm all about skin safety."

Faye laughed. "I'm sure you are. When's your next break?"

"Whenever you want."

"The staff on this ship is very accommodating," Faye said to Austin.

When Lifeguard Mike rose, Austin couldn't miss the bulge in the man's red speedo. Mike seemed to notice him looking and winked. "Your wife's got great skin, bro." With that, he dove into the pool, cutting through the sparkling water, and was gone.

Faye handed the bottle of lotion to Austin, who sat at the edge of the lounge chair and began to work it into her skin. "You got in late last night," she said as she settled back onto the lounge.

"Yeah, I... I really don't remember much." His kiss with Cassandra and that brunette jolted through his brain. But he really *didn't* remember much.

Like, he had no idea how he got back to the room. “Did I... did I say anything when I got home?”

Faye snorted. “You kept telling me how much you *loved* me. How many of those special drinks did you have?”

“One, I think?”

“My sweet, sweet lightweight.”

That rubbed him the wrong way. A little empathy couldn’t kill her—

“Why didn’t you respond to any of my texts?” she asked.

“Oh, right. I think I fried my phone. It got soaked.”

She turned her head to look up at him, and he could just see her eyes through the dark lenses of her glasses. “So that’s why you were all wet last night. And you just jumped into a pool with your clothes on? What are you, twenty?”

“It wasn’t a pool, exactly,” he said, feeling the itch of embarrassment along his neck. Embarrassment and something more.

“I *knew* that I shouldn’t have left you alone...”

“I mean, probably not? I *was* high. For the *first time*.” This was not like Austin, and yet once he started to speak, he couldn’t seem to stop. “Surrounded by horny, available women. You’re lucky that my phone and clothes were the *only* things that got wet.”

Faye’s mouth actually dropped open. He was glad that he couldn’t see her eyes fully, and the longer she stared at him without speaking, the more sweat began to build up under his shirt. He was about to apologize when an announcement came on over the speakers around them.

“Greetings, cruisers. This is Felicity Jones, your Cruise Director. For tonight, we have a surprise announcement. There has been a slight change in our entertainment program for the evening. The Fischer String Quartet, that did such a great show on our first day at sea, has changed their program. They are going to feature sensual music to get us all in the mood. And, they have made a special request. They want everyone to come in their slinkiest attire. They will do the same.”

The people around the pool started to buzz with excitement.

“The Captain has agreed to allow lingerie wear, if that is your choice, though he reminds us that full nudity remains banned in public spaces. Enjoy the show!”

“Please tie my top,” Faye said, settling her head back down onto her hands. “I think I need to take a dip in the pool.”

Austin almost refused, but his suddenly rebellious spirit caught on the wind and blew away. He tied the string bikini top. Only then did he realize how tiny the pale blue suit was. "Is this new?" he asked, running his fingers along the thong back.

"Oh, you noticed," she said. "Surprised you could take your eyes off of all these other horny, available women."

"C'mon, Faye, you know what I meant."

Bikini top tied, she sat up and turned, placing a hand on his face. Her touch was firm. Not a slap, but for Austin it landed like one. "I know that I'm going to need to keep my eye on you from now on."

Austin nodded, thinking one last time of Cassandra. That was fair. Mostly.

"OH, GOD... OH, MY GOD!" Faye was bouncing on Mike Johnson's cock. They were on the two-person sofa in the cabin that Faye shared with Austin. Faye was even now straddling the lifeguard, facing away. Facing her husband. She still wore her pale blue bikini top, although Mike had pulled the cups down and was twisting and tweaking her long and swollen nipples. *Faye hates when I do that*, Austin thought sourly. But of course with Mike, she was cooing and moaning.

"He's so fucking big!"

That was directed at Austin, who was positioned in the desk chair across the small room from them. She wasn't wrong. Mike Johnson certainly had a big johnson. He'd watched Faye slobber all over it when they'd come back to the room, kneeling on the floor, teasing Austin with her thong bikini bottoms.

Austin knew the drill. They'd done this before—taken a man back to their hotel room to have some fun. As with all of those other times, Faye's actions made Austin both uncomfortable and aroused. So aroused. He wasn't permitted to play with himself, not yet, so he just sat there in his chair, still fully clothed, and watched as Faye rode the bronzed bull, all the while pinning her husband with her stare.

"Does this turn you on, baby?" she asked, her electric blue eyes boring into him.

“Yes.”

“You like seeing a real man take your wife?”

He didn’t answer. He wouldn’t answer. As much as he liked watching his bride play, lately, her frequent attempts at emasculation had begun to leave a bad taste in his mouth.

“His dick feels so... ohhh... big!”

Her bikini bottoms were long gone, giving Austin an unobstructed view of Mike’s fat dick spreading open Faye’s compact pussy, the narrow dart of hair on her mound pointing to the adulterous sight like a taunt.

“Maybe more like you’re so tight,” Mike said. He lifted her off of him, muscles straining, and turned her to face him. She happily climbed back on, guiding his dick back into her. This time, they started to kiss as they fucked. Austin’s cheeks burned. His angst grew.

“You can play with yourself,” Faye said. “But no coming.”

Austin heard Mike chuckle. His cheeks burned brighter. But the shame was not enough to stop him from running his fingers over the bulge in his shorts. He wasn’t going to get naked in front of the bull. His fingers on either side of his shaft felt just fine.

Mike pulled on the ties that held Faye’s thong on, tossing the scrap of cloth away so he could fully grope her tight little butt.

“Oh, Austin, he’s going so deep!”

“You like that, don’t you?” Mike said. There was an edge to his voice. He was getting close too.

“I love it. Love it when guys do things that Austin over there never could.”

Her words stung. Once, maybe that was what he wanted—the sting, that cuckold pain. She might say these things, but she didn’t really mean them.

Only maybe she did. Only maybe this wasn’t a kinky game to get them closer.

Mike saw Austin’s expression change. “Uh oh, looks like you hit a nerve.”

Faye looked back and winked. “He’s good,” she said. “He likes it. He likes seeing me satisfied.”

How would you know, Faye? he thought to himself. *When was the last time you checked in with how I’m feeling about things, instead of just assuming that a stiff cock is proof enough that everything is a-ok?*

“Then let’s make sure you’re satisfied!” the lifeguard crowed.

With strength that Austin never would have, Mike stood, lifted Faye up, her legs still wrapped around his waist, and carried her to the bed. Without ever letting her go, he set her down and continued to fuck her, this time from above.

Austin watched the cords of the man's back muscles work, flexing and shifting as he pounded Faye. His wife lost it, moaning hard, begging for Mike's come.

It was still exciting to watch. Austin was still hard the whole time. But the thrill, the adrenalin rush, were both muted, the way it felt to jerk off like this through his shorts. The *pow* wasn't there. The *umph* had gone out.

Mike pulled out of Faye before he came, grabbing her by the hair and shoving his dick into her mouth and down her throat. Austin gasped at the aggression, but Faye didn't struggle. Instead, she sucked away, touching herself as she swallowed Mike's load.

"Fuck, I love my job," Mike growled as he stood back in all of his naked glory. He was completely bronzed, not even a tan line.

Faye propped herself on her elbows, lifted her legs and stroked his flaccid cock with her feet. "You are very good at it. Want to go to that kinky orchestral show with me?"

Not 'us,' Austin noted. *'Me.'*

"Not really my kind of music, but I wouldn't mind the eye candy."

Mike started to harden again as she stroked him with her toes. "Then it's a date. I'm not done with you."

Austin cleared his throat. Faye looked over, as if remembering him for the first time in a long while.

"Oh, you'll come, too. Having you watching is almost half of the fun." She turned back to Mike. "Now, let's see if we can get that dick back up, shall we?"

The Grand Stage was alive. Champagne was being passed on trays by servers wearing very little—both men and women. The atmosphere was that of a gala, yet the dress code was closer to that of a Victoria's Secret runway show.

Cassandra thought that she'd be underdressed in her lacy black camisole. Not only did it barely reach the top of her thighs, but it was transparent enough that her black thong was readily visible. She needn't have worried. Some women wore nothing but a bra and panties—one brunette forewent even the bra, opted for a pair of pasties that covered a pair of tits almost as perfect as her own.

"I'm getting some ideas for next year's Christmas party," Marshall said. He looked dapper in the black George Cleverley brogue boots she had gotten him for Christmas, his favorite tight black Brioni trousers, and to top it off, a crisp blue Tom Ford shirt, untucked and with three buttons open.

"I don't think that most of our social group would go along with those ideas, honey," Cassandra said with a laugh.

Marshall's eyes sifted through the crowd. Cassandra wasn't sure if he was checking out all the skin, or looking for someone for her. "Then we should change our social circle."

"But then who will I exchange baking tips with if I didn't have Alyssa Stevens?"

“Then you’ll have to initiate Alyssa into the lifestyle. I bet she’d be fun.”

“She’s the head lector at St. Patrick’s!”

“It’s the quiet ones that are the most fun.” He turned to her. “Remember how you were when we first met?”

Cassandra peered sideways up at her husband. “Feels like a lifetime ago...”

Just then, the Fischer String Quartet filed in, and the room quieted down. She’d missed the first night’s performance, although had heard enough buzz about the talented musicians that she was looking forward to this. What she wasn’t prepared for was how attractive they all were.

Two men, two women. The men were good looking, dressed in black shirts and slacks. The violinist had a nervous intensity about him that reminded her of Austin, despite having longer, dark brown hair and brown eyes. The cellist was an attractive black guy with soft, friendly eyes and a confident, yet easy-going, stride. She liked their look, but it was the women who stole the show.

The violist, a sexy Asian woman, was, for all intents and purposes, naked. She wore a bodysuit that left absolutely nothing to the imagination, conforming to her perky breasts, her narrow hips, her runner’s legs. It didn’t even hide the fact that her slit was as bare as Cassandra’s.

The other violinist was a stunning brunette who seemed to feed off the energy of the crowd. She rocked a tight red babydoll that barely contained her full breasts and sexy body. When her eyes met Cassandra’s, though, Cassandra understood her immediately—the two were alike, both liking the attention while not being entirely comfortable with it.

As they began to play, Marshall slipped up behind her, hugging her close. “So who would you fuck,” he murmured in her ear, “if you could have any of them?”

“The cellist,” she said, watching the man’s strong fingers work the strings. “But I’d take any of them.”

The brunette violinist—Ginette Fischer, according to the program—took center stage, seeming to hit her stride as she worked through the sensual music. These four weren’t just sexy eye-candy. This wasn’t a gimmick. This group could play, and for a few moments, Cassandra was transported away from all the anxiety that she’d been carrying around.

She wasn't alone. The crowd was riveted. Even Marshall, horny and sex-focused as he was, seemed moved. The quartet finished their set with a slow and sensual piece that epitomized the night—couples cuddled up, eyes met furtively across the room, everyone's hearts started beating just a little faster. Marshall hadn't released her, and started kissing her on her neck as the brunette finished off her piece.

That's when she saw Austin on the opposite side of the stage. He was alone, but unlike everyone else who was staring at the stage, his gaze was fixed on another couple. The woman with the short bob of blond hair must be his wife, and the large, tanned guy behind her, her bull.

Almost as if he sensed Cassandra's eyes on him, Austin looked her way. Their eyes met for the briefest of skin-prickling, breath-catching moments before she quickly averted her gaze, her face flushing deep red and her breathing suddenly shallow.

"Yeah, that was something," Marshall said, assuming her reaction was to the music.

She turned further away from Austin and forced a smile. "Yeah, they were amazing," she said softly. He leaned down and captured her lips in a kiss. "I think I've changed my mind. I'd do the brunette."

Marshall laughed. "Maybe later. Tonight, you're getting a cock, and I'm going to watch."

Her response was automatic, requiring no thought at all. "Yes, sir."

When he kissed her a second time, it was deeper, more forceful. More insistent. It was a kiss to say, *You may be fucking someone else, but you are not his.*

Her thoughts flashed unbidden back to the kiss she had shared with Austin the previous night. Every bit as intense, but not domineering. In no way possessive. And yet for all that, the kiss, the *feel* of her old beau had tugged at her, drawn her, in ways that she suddenly realized Marshall's heavy-handed control games had failed to do for quite some time. How had they gotten to this point, after all their years together?

"Now, go," he said, spinning her around and patting her ass. "Find us a bull to tame."

Cassandra shimmied her shoulders, fluffed her hair. And then she stepped forward, doing her best to bury thoughts of kissing old boyfriends and apply herself to her latest assigned task.

People were already exiting the hall, moving on to any number of other parties or private events. She considered going up and hitting on the cellist until she saw the way that he was looking at the viola player. They had something going on there, and she decided to give the two space.

“Let’s go to one of the ship’s bars,” she said over her shoulder. “Seems like the Grand Stage is shutting down.”

“Lead the way,” Marshall replied. “I’ll be right behind you. Just don’t try to lose my tail this time.”

Cassandra laughed nervously, doing her best to bat away the images of Austin and their searing kiss that rushed close upon the heels of her husband’s words. “I wasn’t trying to lose you last night, dear.”

“Uh huh.”

She turned back toward him, her gaze searching his face. He had the look of the hunter, his game face for seeking out new cock for her. His “kink face,” she sometimes called it, only half-joking.

Not for the first time that day, guilt washed over her. She *had* to do better. Marshall was so committed to their shared games, and all she seemed capable of doing lately was mooning over a lost love. She might as well be stalking Austin late at night on Facebook, mainlining Chardonnay as she did so.

And with that thought Cassandra reached out and stroked her husband’s cheek as tenderly as she knew how, and moved to give him her best loving kiss. “Tonight is for you then, babe.”

“And for you,” he added.

“Turning you on turns me on.” The unthinking, knee-jerk nature of her second nearly-automatic response to her husband in a five minute window threw her off. *Am I just his slutty Barbie after all?*

She covered her reaction by saying, “Now let’s go find someone.”

When they exited the hall, Cassandra spotted Austin and his wife, presumably, accompanied by the tall and tanned bull. The bull, who she recognized as one of the ship’s many lifeguards, was talking to Austin’s wife, who for her part was listening with great interest, her mouth half-open, as if trying to decide whether to be scandalized or not.

The woman was attractive. Strikingly so. She was the kind of woman that Cassandra had once wanted to be, and now perhaps who she was. Unlike many of the attendees to the performance, she wore an actual dress, although the LBD was short enough and tight enough to pass for lingerie.

The lifeguard gestured to another trio—two women and a man. Cassandra had seen the man around, tall, built, made of the same square-jawed masculinity that seemed in abundance aboard the *Princess*. He was the chief butler, she thought, Lawrence or something. He seemed to be having a similar conversation with the two women, a blonde and a brunette who wore nothing but bras, panties, and a “coverup” that was about as effective as the one she wore in Nassau. Like Austin’s wife, they looked both surprised and intrigued, giggling to one another.

Austin’s wife turned in his direction, her brows going up as she asked him something. *Well, shall we?*

Whatever was going on there, Austin was clearly uncomfortable. Cassandra recognized his hesitation. She’d felt it herself, plenty of times in her own marriage. She considered stepping in when at that very moment, Austin glanced over, spotting her again.

This time it was Austin’s turn to quickly look away.

Cassandra sighed. Last night had been such a mistake. She should have forgone hanging out with him and just helped him back to his room and into the care of his wife. Now everything was awkward.

She tried again to put it all out of her mind and instead focus on the task at hand, one that was kind of the whole point of this cruise: to be a hotwife.

“THE RESPLENDENT *PORTHOLE* PARTY?” Austin asked, eyes hopping from Faye to Mike to the new guy, Lawrence.

“It’s just a clever name for a gloryhole party, bro,” Mike Johnson said with his annoying confidence. “Porthole because it’s a ship—“

“I get it.” He turned to Faye, who was looking at him expectantly. “And you want to go.”

“Sounds fun. ‘When in Rome,’ right? I like sucking cock, and I love it when you watch me.”

“I don’t know about this, honey...” He happened to look out at the people flowing from the theater just as Cassandra emerged. Their eyes locked for a second before he hastily looked away in embarrassment. “I think I’m going to call it a night.”

Faye stared at him, visibly willing him to bend to her.

He refused, saying, “You go, though. ‘When in Rome.’”

Faye glanced at Mike apologetically and took Austin aside. “If you don’t come, there is no telling what you’ll miss. This could get pretty wild.”

“I’m sure it will.” Austin sighed. His wife’s eyes widened slightly at his response.

Normally he would go after some prodding—Faye had once affectionately referred to him as being more easily swayed than a drunk flamingo in a windstorm. Not tonight. He knew where the evening would lead, especially at a party designed for women to suck anonymous dick, none of which would be his. Best case, he left with a greater case of blue balls than he already had. Worst case? Faye humiliated him and made him join her at the hole. Not that she’d do that. Would she?

But he wasn’t going to find out. “But I’m *tired*, Faye. I’m still beat from last night, and I just want to crawl into bed. I was half-asleep at the concert.”

Faye studied him as if trying to decide whether to push one more time. Austin stepped up and took her into his arms before she could mount another offensive. “Have fun, baby. I’ll be dreaming of my naughty hotwife and all the fun that you’re having.”

Faye kissed him. “Okay then. I’ll see you in the morning.” She slapped his butt. “If you’re lucky.”

“Pretty sure you’re going to be the lucky one.”

Austin felt no regret as he watched Faye and her two admirers move off in the direction of the upper decks. He didn’t want to chase his wife down and ask to go, or for her to stay, or any of it. What he felt was relief and... freedom.

In a more sober frame of mind than he’d been in either of the last couple of nights, he could admit to himself that he’d been feeling that more and more these days. Sometimes life was just easier when he was at work, even when dealing with small town bureaucratic paperwork.

My marriage isn’t in a good place. It was the first time that he’d constructed the thought so deliberately.

It made him sad. He still loved Faye. When he closed his eyes, he still remembered their honeymoon in Spain, or how they met at a fundraiser held in the library and she’d thought that he was the mayor. Question was, did he fight for his marriage?

The answer to that question would have been an easy “yes” before this cruise—before he was reminded that relationships didn’t need to be like this. Before Cassandra.

He didn’t go back to the cabin. Instead, he found himself at the Explorer’s Lounge—not to pick anyone up, but to wallow in self-pity with a fruity rum drink. Seemed fitting.

The lounge was crowded. Apparently he wasn’t the only one who’d moved to this bar after the performance. Plenty of scantily clad women here, still “dressed” in their lingerie outfits. He made his way to the bar, barely seeing any of them.

Of course Cassandra was here. Fuuuck. And of course Joe Greene, of all guys, was hitting on her. For as many people who were on this ship, it was starting to feel way too insular. He ignored them, settling in at the bar.

“What’ll you have?” said the bartender.

Asking for a strawberry daiquiri suddenly felt very emasculating. “I’ll have a... an Old Fashioned.”

“Sure thing. Coming right up.”

The two violinists were here, sitting in a grouping of low-backed leather chairs. They were joined by a third man, large, barrel-chested, with huge arms. A bull. Austin knew the type, and the brunette violinist, still in her red lingerie, was definitely into him. As Austin watched, he appreciated the respect the big guy seemed to show for her husband. When they rose, they rose together, they *left* together.

Joe’s words from the first night came back to him. *Not so fast, little man. Private party. By invitation only.*

Austin had never been invited. Even tonight, he didn’t get the impression that Faye was all that put out that he wasn’t with her.

His eyes inevitably went back to Cassandra and Joe Greene. Seeing her smile, seeing her so engaged with the bull, stung more than Faye abandoning him in favor of a glory hole.

Cassandra was too good for this guy. Austin wasn’t naive. Cass wouldn’t come on a cruise like this if she wasn’t looking to hook up, but even still, she could do better.

He also knew that it was none of his business, and yet he still found himself throwing back his drink, taking a deep breath, and heading over to the two of them.

You'll sit here and wait for us, Joe Green in his head repeated as he threaded his way through the crowded bar, in the direction of his former sweetheart and oversized douchecanoe sniffing around her goods *And while you wait, I want you to think about what's happening to your wife. I want you to imagine my big, hard cock stretching her perfect little pussy. I want you to picture her moaning and screaming my name as I make her cum over and over again.*

Yeah, she might not be his wife, but there was no way he was going to be forced to wallow in those images again.

"Hey, Cassandra!" Austin called out right before reaching the two of them. He really leaned in to the enthusiasm as he came abreast of his ex. Joe Greene registered no recognition when he turned to look at him. He didn't remember Austin, or how he treated him like a cuck. He didn't remember dismissing him.

"This your man?" Joe asked.

"Um, no. He's a... friend." Cassandra grinned at Austin curiously. "Austin, what are you doing here?"

"Wondering if I could get you a drink."

Her grin spread into a smile that felt like the sun coming out from behind a cloud. But before she could get a word out, Joe answered, "I've got that covered. We're good, man."

Cassandra assessed the situation quickly, draining her glass and passing it off to Joe. "And now I need another. Thanks for this one, Joe. It was nice chatting with you."

Joe turned to Austin, and for a moment, Austin was pretty convinced he was about to be punched. Especially when Joe gave Cassandra a once over, checking out the good time that he was giving up. It made Austin even more angry.

"Yeah, thanks for getting her that drink, *Joe*." Even as the words rolled off of his tongue, Austin quailed inside, ready for the beat-down to arrive.

But Joe knew the rules. He was a player. He just held up his hands and smiled. "You two have a good evening. And you, Cassandra, find me if you want another... drink."

When he was gone, Cassandra turned on Austin. "Okay, what was that all about?"

She wasn't angry. She didn't sound annoyed the way Faye would have. She just seemed confused.

“That guy’s a jerk. Your husband wouldn’t have been interested in what he was offering.”

“I wouldn’t?”

Austin turned to find the speaker was none other than the man he’d seen at Cassandra’s side at various moments. He was older, early 50s perhaps, with gray at his temples and a tailored style that spoke of money. No doubt he was a good-looking man, and definitely the kind of guy who tended to get a woman like Cassandra.

Austin was immediately intimidated, but after his exchange with Joe, he also wasn’t going to wilt.

“Not unless you want the true cuck experience,” Austin said, meeting the older man’s eyes. “And you don’t look like that kind of man.”

Cassandra’s husband studied him for a quiet moment, serious and appraising, before he cracked a smile. “You were the guy Cassie spent the first night with, weren’t you. In the booth.”

“Uh, yes.”

“Marshall,” the older man said, holding out his hand. “And you know my wife, Cassandra.”

“I do.” Austin glanced quickly at Cassandra, who all of a sudden looked like a spooked animal. “I’m Austin.”

“You were out with her last night, too. You went to the pool with her.”

Austin was trying to figure out how much Marshall knew, and whether or not the guy was jealous. Most men asking that question would have been, but then again they were amidst people who didn’t react in the normal way. “I did, although honestly, I was on something last night.” He hazarded a crooked sidelong grin in Cass’s direction. Her eyes widened in response, her cheeks reddening adorably. “Don’t really remember all that much.”

“And here you are, again, with my wife.” Marshall put an arm around her as if to make a point. For someone with his particular kink, the guy sure seemed fond of marking his territory. “And tonight, you’re not going to spirit her away.”

“Of course—”

Marshall didn’t let him finish. “Because tonight, I’m going to *watch* as you fuck her.”

“I ’m going to *watch* as you fuck her.”

Cassandra felt a rush at her husband’s order. She always did when he got this way. She knew most would consider it a weakness that she liked to give in to his desires. She’d always been that way. She was a sub, and yes, over the years, the things that she did for Marshall got more and more extreme, but it always felt good to do as she was told—the naughtier, the better.

This order, coming at *this* moment, on *this* ship, with *this* man, felt like diving off the Horizon Deck only to realize how far down the water was.

Cassandra knew that she should tell Marshall who Austin was. She’d been leading Marshall on to keep him happy, making him think that she’d already hooked up with Austin, but the white lie had run its course.

Before she could figure out how to confess, though, Austin shrugged. “Not the way I thought things would go tonight, but you know what?” He looked right at Cassandra. “I’m game if you are.”

She couldn’t agree more with his first statement, and she realized that she was up for the second, too. She slipped her hand into Austin’s first, then Marshall’s. “Come on, our cabin awaits.”

CASSANDRA HADN'T BEEN this nervous since the first time she'd been with a man while Marshall watched, the night she became a hotwife. That was almost five years ago. Marshall had floated the idea slowly at first, sharing books and watching movies that featured the theme. He'd get so worked up whenever she told him that a guy had hit on her at the gym. Their horse trainer was a guy named Hank, good natured Montana-native whom Marshall always teased her about.

One day, Marshall invited Hank over to their place after a hard day of riding. After a few drinks and under the intoxicating eye of her husband, Cassandra had started to make out with Hank. She could still smell his musk, even now, the scent of a man at work. She'd ended up naked, blowing him while Marshall watched. The rush was as strong as any drug, and when Marshall told Hank to fuck her, she nearly came before he was even inside of her.

Cassandra could still remember the way Hank had looked at her, and the way Marshall had watched. Hank was so different from her husband. She loved the feel of his calluses and the smell of horse that he could never fully wash away. She loved that he was different, new. But most of all, she loved what it had done to Marshall—the intensity of her husband, the way he'd ravaged her when Hank left, the feeling of being reclaimed.

Here she was feeling that heady storm of emotions all over again. Only it wasn't Marshall's intense gaze bringing the thunder this time. It was Austin's.

As for Marshall, she could sense him at the edges of her consciousness, stalking along the periphery of the room. But it was Austin she couldn't stop staring at. The way he continued to look at her...

"Cassandra—"

She silenced him with a kiss. No more talk. She knew that at any moment this whole scene could come crumbling down. It was wrong. She was withholding a huge truth from her husband, and yet in that moment, she needed this. She pressed her body to Austin's, smiling into the kiss as his hands went to her hips, to her lower back, to her butt.

She pulled Austin's shirt off. He wasn't cut like some of the other men walking around The Princess, but like her, he'd changed over the years, going from the runner with a wiry frame to something closer to a footballer, a rugby player, a man. Not that she needed any of that. It was just a nice bonus.

They kissed again, but she wanted more, and she could feel between his legs that he did, too. “You smell the same,” she whispered into his ear, quiet enough that Marshall couldn’t hear. She felt guilty for keeping her husband in the dark, yet at the same time, excited by her own small rebellion. “I bet you taste the same, too.”

Austin’s eyes went wide, maybe panicked, as if he wanted to stop her when she sank to her knees. But of course he didn’t. No man would.

She knew what she did to men. She knew the power she had now. She loved that she could show it to Austin.

Unzipping him, she only took her eyes off of his long enough to survey his cock, erect and ready. She was surprised to find that his cock and balls were shaved bare. Her eyes sparkled as she ran her fingers over him, licking her lips before diving in.

“Uh!” Austin groaned. His eyes fluttered shut. He threaded his fingers into her hair as he steadied himself in place. She began to suck, bobbing along his length, slowly exploring him. She remembered this dick, although back then, she wasn’t as avid a cocksucker. She remembered the sounds that he used to make, the gasps, the murmurs, the approving hums.

He was fully erect almost immediately, and because he wasn’t as large as most of her bulls, she could easily swallow him to the root, taking him into her throat. That was a nice change.

But because he was also not a true bull, he wasn’t going to be able to last long, and she wasn’t sure how easily he’d get it back up. After just a few strokes with her mouth, she pulled off and stood.

“Time for you to fuck me,” she said as she ran her hand along his arm and moved to the bed.

Marshall was sitting in a chair that he’d pulled up beside the bed. He was already naked, slowly stroking his cock, his fervid gaze locked on Cassandra. How many times had he looked at her like that as she guided another man to bed? Every other time she had done so *for* Marshall. She’d become her husband’s fantasy woman. The man she’d fucked was just a toy.

This was different. As Cassandra peeled her lingerie off, she was doing it for more than just Marshall. She was doing it for Austin and, if she was being honest... for herself.

Her ex stepped up behind her, helping her pull the tight, lacy slip from her curves. When he touched her skin, he did it with a tenderness that most bulls lacked. When she crawled onto the bed, splaying naked, giving Austin

an uninhibited view of her pinup body, she couldn't wait for what came next.

She crooked a finger at him, feeling the anticipation build. He looked almost shy as he approached her, and yet, as with *all* men who came between her thighs, she saw the hunger, too. She spread them wider and took his cock in her hand as he knelt above her.

"Mmm, you feel so good, Austin..."

"Oh fuck," he groaned as she rubbed his dick along her smooth and completely bare mound.

"You like it?" she whispered, pulling his body over hers with her free hand. "Enjoy this."

With that, she guided his cock against her opening. Austin thrust, sinking deep inside of her, drawing a moan from both their throats.

When she opened her eyes, she was startled to see him looking down at her, eyes open, locking onto hers. She caressed his cheek tenderly as their hips found a rhythm, moving together as one. She wrapped her legs around his waist, pulling him deeper.

"Ohhh Austin... you feel incredible..."

She kissed him passionately, losing herself in the moment. Her hands roamed over his muscular back and shoulders as he started thrusting steadily. Pleasure coursed through her, all thoughts of being a hotwife momentarily forgotten. They weren't just fucking. This wasn't purely for sport or entertainment. They were making love.

Cassandra clenched her pussy around his cock with each thrust, drawing a groan from her lover. She wanted to show off. She wanted Austin to feel every trick that she'd developed over the years. Yet at the same time, this all felt like climbing beneath the warm blanket of her past. She'd been with many men since Austin had walked out of her life, but as she breathed in his familiar scent and felt his familiar dick, she realized just how much he'd remained with her.

"Mmm yes Austin, just like that... you're fucking me so good. Your cock feels amazing inside me..."

She raked her nails down his back and rocked her hips against him urgently. She wanted to make this incredible for him, stroking his hair as he started to thrust faster. "Yes, baby. Like that. Harder. You won't break me."

Austin's cock throbbed and swelled inside her. He was close. He was so close. Reaching up, she cupped his face and looked deep into his blue eyes.

“Fuck it into me, Austin. I want you. I want to feel your come inside of me.”

He drove his hips harder, faster, burying his face in her hair. She ran her fingers along his back and dug her heels into his ass, urging him to go faster and harder.

“Oh, Cass, you feel so fucking good,” he groaned.

“Do it. Come!”

He thrust one last time, his breath catching, even as he once again sank his iron bar of a cock balls deep into her. For one moment, the world held still. Then—

“Oh, fuck!” His cock pulsed, releasing his seed deep in her welcoming pussy. She wrapped her arms and legs around him tightly, never wanting to let go, lost in the bliss of their union.

But Austin did let go, rolling onto his side, and suddenly Marshall was there, pushing his cock into her.

“You like that, my little slut?” He folded her legs over, urging her to flip over onto her hands and knees. “I can tell that you did. Now suck him back to hardness while I reclaim you.”

Cassandra looked into Austin’s eyes, trying to hold onto the beautiful connection they’d just shared even as Marshall attempted to reassert his dominance. She’d touched a nerve in her husband. Then again, she’d touched all kinds of nerves in herself. As her husband slid his cock into her pussy, still slick and full of Austin’s come, she knew that there was only one thing to do.

Enjoy it.

“Come here, Austin,” she said, directing him onto his back, higher up the bed, so she could reach out and wrap her hand around his soft dick. “Let me help you get hard again.”

Marshall felt good inside her as he worked away at his attempted reclamation. But that wasn’t what she was after. Not in this moment. She looked up at Austin, and even through the haze of pleasure, she could still feel the connection with her former lover.

“You don’t have to...” Austin began.

“I know,” she said huskily. “But *I* want to.”

With the emphasis on herself reverberating through her body, she wrapped her mouth around him, swirling her tongue around his shaft. She wanted to pleasure him, to make him feel as incredible as he made her feel.

She cupped his balls and stroked his thighs, lavishing his cock with attention until he was fully erect once more.

This only seemed to spur Marshall further. He redoubled his efforts, hammering her roughly from behind, grunting with each thrust. Cassandra moaned in response, sending pleasurable vibrations up and around the cock in her mouth. She watched Austin, keeping eye-contact, and it was that connection which suddenly had her on the edge of release.

Then his eyes shifted up and away, back to where Marshall was drilling her. His dick lurched in her mouth. His breath caught. Marshall had watched her get taken countless times, but she'd never felt more turned on than in that moment, as her ex-boyfriend watched her get taken. Austin was like the voyeur that she'd never realized she'd always wanted.

Again she moaned loudly around Austin's shaft, and then again, the vibrations sending pleasurable shivers through him. Her tongue swirled and teased, amplifying her own pleasure. And behind her, as if trying to prove himself, Marshall fucked her harder. She arched her back more, giving both men an unobstructed view of her dripping pussy and jiggling ass. Her free hand reached up to stroke Austin's chest and abs, exploring his once-again familiar body.

"He's hard again," Marshall said.

She pulled off of him long enough to glance back. "Oh yeah, baby."

Marshall spit on her asshole, pulling out briefly, only to press it against her butt. "Great. Ready for some DP action, Austin?"

Cassandra's eyes shot open as Marshall pressed his thick cock against her tight little asshole. He only did this when he was most worked up. He only did this when he wanted to flex his absolute dominance. Yet as she looked up into Austin's eyes, she realized that Marshall had no power over her. Not anymore.

"Oh, fuck!" she cried as Marshall pushed into her ass, stretching her open. She glanced back at him, spreading her asscheeks for her, all the while feeling Austin watching her, getting turned on by her, ready to do this thing... with her!

A tremble of fear rolled through her as doubt crept in. What would Austin think of her, taking two cocks at once like a total slut? Marshall's dick in her ass chased the doubt away. The sensation was overwhelming, but so incredibly pleasurable.

“Cassie loves it in the butt,” Marshall said, slapping her ass cheek. “But she loves taking two cocks at once even more, don’t you, baby doll?”

“Yes,” she said, staring at Austin, trying to read his expression.

He didn’t look disgusted at all. Instead, his expression mirrored what she herself was feeling.

He looked hungry.

“Shimmy up his body, Cassie. Time to take him back in that tight cunt of yours.”

Cassandra nodded in response to Marshall’s words, feeling nervous but excited to have Austin’s cock inside her again. She crawled up his body, straddling his waist, all the while keeping Marshall buried in her butt. She stroked Austin gently as she positioned herself over him, once again meeting his eyes. Seeing his caring gaze there, she smiled softly. She wanted him to know that this was special for her, too.

That *he* was special to her.

Slowly, she sank down onto his length, letting out a contented sigh as Austin once again filled her, stretched her, joining her husband’s cock inside of her. Her head fell back in bliss once both men were fully sheathed inside of her.

“Fuck, that feels so full...” she groaned. Glancing over her shoulder at Marshall, she said, “Now fuck me.”

She *never* issued orders. Not to Marshall. Not to her bulls. She was the recipient. She was the fuck toy. But something had come over her. Something inspired by Austin.

She began to ride Austin’s cock. Marshall, momentarily stunned, came back alive. “You like that, don’t you, dirty girl.”

“Yes!” she hissed, pressing her body to Austin’s. She moaned in pleasure, arching her back to offer her large breasts to Austin. His mouth felt amazing on her sensitive nipples, causing her to rock her hips faster, taking him deeper. She ran her fingers through his hair, holding him close as they both drove into her. She was happy that she was facing him. She was happy that it was Austin she could kiss as she got so thoroughly fucked.

She ground down on his cock harder and faster, rocking her hips more urgently, squeezing him with each movement.

“Ohhh Austin, your cock feels so good... mmm...”

She kissed him deeply, pouring all her pent up feelings for him into it.

Marshall started fucking her ass harder from behind, each thrust sending a shockwave of pleasure through her body. It was punishment in the best way. It was penance. It was so good, and all the while, she held Austin, gazing down at him, knowing that the end was coming soon.

She rocked her hips faster and harder, impaling herself on their cocks with desperation. Her body was trembling, coiled and ready to explode.

“Oooh Austin! ‘I’m going to come! I’m going to come!’”

Austin. *Not* Marshall. Not something vague or noncommittal.

She screamed as her body convulsed, her orgasm hitting her like a tidal wave hitting a ship. Marshall was right there with her, pumping his heat into her ass, unable to hold back.

“Come!” she cried. “Give me... give me your come!” *Austin*. This time she held back from calling out his name, but it seemed to ring through the cabin nonetheless.

And with that thought she crested, came hard, holding Austin close, her eyes locked on his in those final, waning moments. After tonight, things would have to go back to the way they were—the way they’d been for longer than she cared to remember .

But for now, in this glorious, all-consuming moment, she allowed herself to dream.

Unlike after the rave the night before, tonight Austin was lucid as he returned to his cabin. More than just lucid. It was like the world had come alive in vibrant color. He was Dorothy entering Oz.

He could still smell Cassandra on him. He could shut his eyes and still feel her skin, so soft, so smooth. He remembered the way she kissed—more assertive than back when they dated, yet not in the way that Faye was.

But what stuck with him most of all, blazing like a high proof spirit, was watching her take Marshall in her ass. Just thinking those words sent his stomach fluttering, his chest constricting, his scalp burning. All the telltale signs of jealousy and envy and cuckold excitement. All the things that he'd stopped feeling for his own wife. Or maybe never had felt? At least not fully?

"Oh! Oh! Ooohh!"

And of course said wife was going at it hot and heavy when he got back to the cabin. He could hear them fucking before he'd gotten within twenty feet of their door. Loud, hard, and not including her husband: Faye's preferred type of sex these days.

His stomach sank, but not in the good way—not the way that he'd just been feeling.

The volume of Faye's heated coupling only got louder once he'd opened the door. "OH! OH GOD! NGGGGGGGH!!!"

Turned out it was the lifeguard banging Faye. She was still with the lifeguard. That had to be some kind of record. Austin's wife was usually more the "hit it and quit it" type. Funny how long ago that felt. A whole fucking lifestyle ago.

"Honey!" Faye moaned. "Just in time!"

Faye was on her hands and knees, so sweaty that she could have just emerged from the shower. Maybe she had. The lifeguard looked the same, glistening and bronzed.

What was this particular bronzed adonis's name, again? Matthew or Michael or something.

Whatever his name was, the guy didn't look like a real person. None of the bulls on this ship did. Himbos, studs, fuck machines. Austin thought of the guy from the other night. "Stunt Cock." It was like a playground for hotwives—and a boxing ring for the husbands. He wasn't sure he wanted to fight anymore.

"Join us, baby. Let me show you a new trick I picked up." She held out a hand toward her husband.

Austin sighed. The clock on the bedside table read 3am. He really just wanted to sleep, and he sure as hell didn't want to deal with any of *this*.

"I'm good," he said. The bed was occupied, obviously, and the loveseat didn't look comfortable. Tired, he asked, "I don't suppose you two could take this somewhere else?"

"What?" Faye looked at him like he'd said something in a foreign language.

"Never mind." He grabbed a robe and his toothbrush from the bathroom, gave his wife the kind of kiss they shared when he was heading out to work, and left them alone.

He lingered for a moment outside the door, waiting to see if Faye would come running after him. He wasn't sure if he was hoping that she would, or praying that she wouldn't.

A moment later, the sounds of fucking started up again. Austin surprised himself by grinning. All he felt was relief.

SUNRISE on the Horizon Deck was magical. He ended up crashing on a bench up there, using his robe as a blanket. It was warm enough that he got some rest, if only a little, before other couples came out here to watch the sun crest along the edge of the ocean.

He watched them, envious of what they had. One older couple sat cuddled together, her gray hair resting on her partner's thin shoulder. Austin wondered if they were part of the lifestyle, or one of the vanilla passengers. God, what must that be like? To come on here with a bunch of horny couples. He liked the idea that she was still her man's hotwife.

Standing, stretching, he watched until the orange sky burned off, giving way to an endless, azure sky. If there were clouds, they were far off.

Today, the ship was docking in St. Thomas. Of all the ports of call on this cruise, Austin had been most looking forward to this one. He wanted to hike the Mountain Top trail or visit the Coral World Ocean Park. He wanted to wander through the vibrant streets of Charlotte Amalie, or check out Blackbeard's Castle. Faye had been at his side in all of these plans. Now, tourism was the last thing on his mind.

First things first, he needed to figure out where to stay for the latter half of the cruise. He wasn't ready to end his marriage of ten years on a cruise, but he also couldn't imagine sleeping on a deck chair on the Horizon Deck for the next four nights.

"Hi, I was wondering if there were any open cabins," he asked at the main reception hall. The woman standing behind the desk was a stunning blonde, her hair pulled back in a tight ponytail, her features sharp and elegant. Her name tag read, "Inez Lindström," and she had greeted him with a sweet, Scandinavian accent.

Inez frowned at Austin. "Is everything okay? If your cabin is not to your liking—"

"No, it's not that. It's more the... company."

Understanding lit up in her blue eyes. "I see," she said sympathetically. She began to type into her computer. "I'm sorry to hear that, Mr. Reed. If you'd like, I can see if our counselor, Harmony Kang, is free."

A counselor. Yeah, that would probably be necessary at some point. "I appreciate it, but I'm not sure I'm ready for that just yet."

"Of course." She glanced down at her monitor. "We do have a few rooms available, but they're a bit smaller than what you have now. And no balcony."

“That’s fine. I’ll take it.”

She tapped away and nodded. “Done. Compliments of the Princess. We’re sorry that your stay with us hasn’t been great.”

At that moment, the image of Cassandra flashed before him—an innocent one, of her smiling, her eyes lighting up, small crescents of joy.

He felt the same grin crossing his face that had earlier this same morning outside what was now his wife’s cabin. “I wouldn’t say that,” he said. “It’s just not been what I was expecting.”

A new room secured, Austin returned to his old one. Time to face this music, no matter how unpleasant. He wondered what he’d do if the lifeguard was still in there. Mercifully, his wife was alone.

“There you are,” Faye said. She actually looked worried. “Where have you been?”

She rose from the bed. She was dressed for the day, in a cute sundress, her sunglasses pushed up into her short, honey-blond locks. Unlike him, she looked showered and smelled clean.

“Slept outside under the stars.”

Faye’s brow furrowed. She floated over to him. “Why didn’t you stay?” She touched his face like she was afraid he’d crumble. “I wanted you to stay.”

“And I didn’t.” He took a deep breath. “That’s kind of what I want to talk to you about.”

“What?”

He looked around. Despite Faye looking daisy fresh, the room was in shambles, a jumbled, reeking reminder of her night of debauchery—and his.

“Not here. Want to go check out St. Thomas?”

“I CAN’T DO this anymore, Faye.” They were sitting at a cafe along the waterfront. The ocean was so clear, a vibrant turquoise that looked like it was taken from a postcard. “I can’t be the man that I think you want me to be.”

Faye was calm. Suspiciously so. Austin kept waiting for her to go off on him, but instead, she looked thoughtful. “What do you think I want you to

be?” she asked quietly.

“A... a cuckold?”

“And you’re not?”

Austin winced. “Technically, sure. But you know what I mean.”

“I really don’t,” Faye said. “You say that a lot lately: ‘You know what I mean’, and honestly, sometimes I really have no clue what’s going on with you.”

Austin rolled his eyes. “I doubt you’ve given it much thought,” he said.

“But I’m trying to understand, honey. I want to.” She reached for his hand. “Help me understand.”

“I don’t... like the way you treat me... I don’t like being... humiliated.” That was one of the hardest things that he’d ever admitted in his life. Once it was out, though, the weight was off his shoulders. “You make me feel small.”

Faye didn’t say a thing. She didn’t react. Her face was as still as a pool as she studied him. Her eyes narrowed, just a touch, before she finally spoke. And as she did, she drew her hand back. “Does this have anything to do with the stacked blonde you’ve been eye-fucking these last few days?”

Austin blinked at her. “What?”

“The one from last night, at the concert. The one who looks like a Barbie with those big, fake tits.”

“How do you—”

“I have eyes, too, Austin. I see things.”

“Then why don’t you see me?” he mumbled under his breath.

“What was that?” she snapped.

Austin pinched the bridge of his nose and sighed. Clearer and louder this time, he said, “Then why don’t you see *me*, Faye? You want me on a leash, and I’m done with it.” His voice shook. “I came on this trip hoping that we could reconnect, and make this work. But if anything, just the opposite has happened. There’s been a flashing ‘WELCOME’ sign hanging above your bed seemingly for every man onboard *except* for *me*. The whole thing has given me some surprising clarity.”

Faye pursed her lips. “That what you want is some bimbo?” She seemed to realize that she was coming on too strong. She softened her tone, her face, once again reaching out for him. “You don’t, baby. You need someone to challenge you. You need someone to push you. Maybe I push you too far, but without it, you’d be—”

“Happy? Content? My own person?” He pulled his hand away from hers.

“You’d be fucking nothing,” she spat. Then her eyes went wide. Even Faye realized that she’d crossed a line. She lowered her eyes and shook her head quickly. “I’m sorry. I didn’t mean that.”

“You sure? I think that deep down, you’ve always felt that way.”

“Austin—”

“You remember how this whole hotwife thing began? I walked in on you at one of your work parties, and you were just about to go down on your fucking *boss*.”

“And you *watched*,” she said, her eyes glittering. “You just stood there and fucking *watched*, with your dick so hard you needed to adjust it.”

“I should have ended it then. Put my fist through his smirking face and dragged—”

“So why didn’t you?” she broke in. “Because you *like* it. You like to *watch*. You get off on it. It’s what you need, and what *I* can provide.”

“Wow.”

“You *know* it’s true,” Faye pressed, every second seeming more sure of herself as she rolled out her familiar script. Austin had heard it all before, every time he had raised the tiniest objection to their “new dynamic.” Why was he only *now* pushing back?

And then he thought about Cassandra again and her lovely, laughing crescent-shaped eyes. “You know the best thing about a hotwife cruise?” He said as he stood up. “Seeing all the different available flavors of this lifestyle. Sure, I may like to watch, but I know now that what we have... what we *had*... isn’t my preferred taste at all.”

“Where are you going?”

“I’m not sure. I need to walk, and I’ve heard good things about the trail up to Mountain Top.” He looked at her impractical heels. “I’d ask you to join me, but I don’t want to spoil the hike.”

“Austin,” she said, a warning in her voice. Then, with more concern as she realized that he was being serious, “Austin?”

“We’ll talk, Faye. But later. After the cruise. Right now I just... I just can’t.”

With that, he walked away.

Cassandra woke up exhausted the day after her threesome with Austin. Her body was sore. Her throat was raw from all the moaning and cock sucking. Her butt still hurt from Marshall's rough anal sex. But she wasn't just exhausted from the double penetration.

It went deeper than that. This was emotional. She couldn't close her eyes and *not* see Austin, feel the charge from his body against hers, the decadent burn of his beard against her skin everywhere from the nape of her neck, across her nipples, to her labia, the way he looked at her... and the insistent thrum it all set off in her heart, to say nothing of the heat kindling in her belly

She closed her eyes and didn't want to open them again. She wanted to stay in bed, if only to dream a little longer.

And all that made her feel awful. *You're married*, she reminded herself, *you have a man you love. Games are games, and fun is fun, but you made a commitment.*

Usually the thought of her bond with Marshall was enough to silence her mind on mornings such as this one. Not this time.

Should this sort of commitment feel so one-sided? The thought came despite her best efforts to block it out. Followed closely by, *when exactly did proving my love become so exhausting?*

Doing her best to ignore her back-talking inner voice, Cassandra spent the day doting on Marshall all around Charlotte Amalie. As if to prove to

him—and maybe to herself—that she was being silly.

“This is nice.” They sat at a bar that opened up along one of the market streets, sipping rum drinks with umbrellas and fruit garnishes. She covered his hand with her own, lacing her fingers through his. His wedding band was warm. “Maybe we should just stay here the rest of the days.”

Marshall laughed. “Getting tired of our small cabin?”

“Maybe I just like solid ground.” *Or maybe I don’t want to run into Austin again*, she didn’t say.

“You okay?” Marshall asked, turning to her. “You seem off.”

“Yeah. Just tired. Last night was...” She trailed off, thinking that she saw Austin walk by a block away. But no, just some other guy with light brown hair and a beard.

“Last night *was* something,” Marshall said, sipping his drink. “Think we can top it tonight?”

“I’m not sure my body can take it!”

“Please,” he said, sliding his free hand up the inside of her thigh. “I’ve seen this body take a *lot* more.”

Cassandra shivered at that. She closed her thighs around his hand, but her pussy was already tingling.

“You know, there are areas marked by platinum ropes. They indicate playrooms,” he said. “Maybe we dip into one of those tonight?”

Partly because the thought *did* arouse her and partly because she knew what was expected of her, Cassandra smiled at her husband and said, “Sounds perfect.”

CASSANDRA WRAPPED both hands around the man’s impressive dick. She made sure to stare up at him as she took him into her mouth, knowing how much guys liked eye contact. She liked it, too, and there was no hiding it when locking gazes. There was a vulnerability for both of them. She didn’t even know this guy’s name, but they were having a moment.

“God, you are *sexy*,” he groaned.

Cassandra encircled the crown of his cock once before popping off of it. “And you’ve got a big dick. Let me guess, at least nine-inches?”

“So you’ve heard of our little club.” He winked at her, eyes as dark as his hair. “I’m Paul.”

“Cassandra,” she said. She glanced over at Marshall, who was sitting in a nearby armchair, watching her. It was thrilling—being watched was *always* thrilling. And usually in a room like this, surrounded by moans, hotwives, hot men, coupled with the way she could feel everyone looking in her direction, hoping that she’d shed her tight, silver cocktail dress, it would all swirl into a heady cocktail that only served to stoke her own desire.

And yet it all somehow just felt flat now compared to how Austin had made her feel last night. Like a sauce that was missing spice.

“So Paul,” she said, batting that thought away. “Want me to fuck you with my tits?” She said it as much for Marshall as for Paul. This time, she didn’t look over at her husband, but kept her eyes focused on her bull as she pushed the spaghetti straps of her dress off of her shoulders.

“I’ve been hoping to ever since you walked in,” Paul said, staring unabashedly at her boobs. “They kind of command attention.”

“Best money can buy.” Her tits free, she went back to sucking him, taking his cock all the way into her throat before pulling back. Pushing her tits together in her hands, she looked down at her cleavage and released a long, sticky strand of saliva. Even that was as much for show as it was for utility. She heard Paul’s breath catch and grinned inwardly. It wasn’t easy to get a seasoned bull like this to gasp. “There, that should do it.”

Leaning forward, she wrapped her tits around Paul’s thick dick. He was shaved bare—*don’t think of Austin*—and somehow felt both soft and hard against her breasts. “Look at how hot that is,” she said to him, her own eyes watching his cock move along her chest. “God, you feel even bigger between my titties.”

A woman joined Paul on the sofa, throwing an arm around him and kissing him passionately. She was beautiful with long, blond hair, high cheekbones, and smooth, creamy skin.

Cassandra was confused, but she’d been around the block enough times to just go with it. This woman wasn’t clawing her eyes out, and when she broke the kiss and looked at Cassandra, her smile told the whole story. “Well, hello there,” the blonde said. “You are fucking hot.”

“Thanks.” Cassandra preened at the compliment. She raked her eyes across the other woman’s body, naked other than black thigh-highs and a pair of Loub’s. “So are you.”

“Mind if I join you?” The woman slipped down to her knees just behind Cassandra, her nipples hard and long as she pressed them into Cassandra’s back. “I’m Heather, by the way. Paul’s wife.”

Heather ran her hands up Cassandra’s body, cupping her tits just beneath her own hands.

“I see. I thought he was one of the L.O.N.G. bulls.”

“Oh, he is.” Heather looked up at Paul with an expression that reminded Cassandra of... she pushed the thought away before his name could form in her head. The blonde continued, “But when I heard about this cruise, I just couldn’t resist.”

“Heather’s a hotwife too,” Paul said.

“And we’re all about sharing,” Heather added. She leaned in over Cassandra’s shoulder, and Cassandra turned her head to meet the other woman’s lips. The kiss came so naturally, and all the while, she could feel the eyes of their husbands on them.

Heather broke the kiss and helped Cassandra out of her dress. “Don’t stop titty-fucking my man, please. He’s a sucker for big tits.”

If there was any doubt that they were on a lifestyle cruise, that night put it all to rest. The titfuck transitioned to a double blowjob, Heather working one side of him, Cassandra working the other. They’d kiss. They’d suck his balls. And eventually Heather said, “You’re so beautiful. I can’t wait to see you fuck my husband.”

So Cassandra climbed up into Paul’s lap and lowered herself onto his big, beautiful cock. “Oh, fuck!” she gasped. Cassandra didn’t consider herself a size queen, but she appreciated a long, thick dick, and Paul’s qualified as both. He also knew how to use it.

As the cherry on top, his wife knew how to complement him. Heather sat at his side, sucking Cassandra’s tits and caressing her skin as Paul drove up into her. “You look so hot together,” she whispered, running her hands between their bodies, rubbing Cassandra’s clit. “Fuck him good, baby.”

The two were clearly a team. Clearly in this for each other, in a way Cassandra had to admit to herself that she and Marshall just were not. And likely never would be.

That thought caused her to squeeze her eyes shut, pick up the pace, lean in to the sensations, savor the feel of Paul’s girthy length inside her, grinding her hips against his, seeking more contact, ever more contact.

“Fuuuck!” he groaned, gripping her waist, taking control, bouncing her up and down on his dick. Cassandra felt her orgasm build, her pussy clenching around his fat dick.

Heather leaned in and kissed Paul, her tongue tangling with his. The sight of them, right there in front of her, pushed her closer to the edge. It hit Cassandra all over again how into one another these two were. The connection they shared crackled between them. Just watching them caused her to glance over at her own husband for the first time in what suddenly felt like hours.

Marshall was there, watching with that intense expression he always got on his face when she did this. But she also felt the gulf there between them, made all the more clear in contrast to Heather and Paul.

“Is he your husband?” Heather asked.

“Yes.”

“She’s amazing,” the blonde said to Marshall.

“I know,” was all he said.

Heather looked like she wanted to say something else, but one glance from Paul and she bit her tongue. Instead, she said to Cassandra, “Why don’t you come all over my husband’s cock. Your man will love that.”

Cassandra did as she was told. She liked following orders, and gladly followed Heather’s. She rode Paul harder and faster, her breath coming in ragged gasps as he met her thrust for thrust. His wife was there, tweaking her nipples, touching her clit, sending her into the clouds.

“I’m gonna come,” she gasped, her voice rising in pitch. “Oh fuck, I’m gonna come so hard.”

“Do it,” Paul groaned. He pulled her down into him, grinding his hips up as her orgasm crashed over her. She cried out, her body shaking, convulsing, coming. She collapsed against Paul’s body, panting and sweaty. Heather kissed them both, her lips soft and gentle.

“That was amazing,” she said, smiling at them.

Cassandra realized that while Heather was talking to the both of them, her words were really directed at Paul. “You two were so hot together.”

She slipped off of Paul’s erect dick, and Heather quickly took her place. They were going at it before Cassandra had even turned fully to Marshall. He held out his hand, beckoning for her to come to his side.

“Enjoy the show?” she asked him.

“You know I did.”

“Come on,” she said, looking around. “Let’s find some more fun things to play with.”

THE NEXT DAY the ship docked in St. Maarten. Normally one to explore, today Cassandra felt completely wiped. She opted to lounge out on the beach beside the main strip in Philipsburg, which was quainter and more European than Charlotte Amalie.

Marshall didn’t seem to mind a slower day, either—especially when she told him that she’d sun in a thong bikini for the sexier tan lines.

That night they had dinner at the Captain’s Table, which, despite the name, was just a classy, low key restaurant in the stern of the ship. It was nice. A pianist played live music against a backdrop of the night sky, soulful, peaceful, romantic. Murmured conversation filtered through the dimly lit space.

The ambience felt perfect for what Cassandra had in mind. It set just the right mood, served as the proper setting for opening up about things. For healing. For finally unburdening herself of the guilt she’d been carrying around since that first night she’d seen Austin.

“Honey?” she said. “I need to tell you something.” All of a sudden, her heart was in her throat. She wished that she could take back her words and the promise of a confession. But they were out, and Marshall was staring at her curiously. “I... I know Austin.”

“You know him?”

“I *knew* him. I dated him a long time ago.” As she spoke, she became more confident that this was the right thing to do. “This was before you. Just after college.”

Marshall leaned back in his chair, quiet, pensive, casting his eyes out past the stern of the ship, where the moonlight caught in its dark wake. Normally, Cassandra bent over backwards to reassure him—especially in situations like this one—to smooth over any conflict. This time, she gave him the space to think, to process, just as she’d had the space to process all day.

At last, he said, “So what are the odds? ‘The one that got away’ on the same lifestyle cruise as us?”

Cassandra leveled her gaze at him. Of course he went there, like this was all a scheme, a plot. It was the way his mind worked. It was maybe something that he himself would orchestrate?

Funny thing was, Austin really wasn't 'the one that got away.' He was just a nice guy she dated during a time when neither of them were grown up enough to start anything special. They were both so very different now.

But she didn't think Marshall would get any of that nuance, and she wasn't going to apologize anymore. Somehow him not getting it just didn't feel like her problem anymore.

"I haven't done the math," she said instead, "but I'd imagine the odds are pretty long."

Marshall snorted. He picked up his glass of wine, swirling it around before tipping it back and drinking. "Yeah," he said, his voice flat. "Sure. Total coincidence "

"Oh, don't be like that, Marsh." Under the table she ran her foot up the inside of his leg. "If I wanted to fuck my ex, I'd just call him up and fuck him. No sense going to the trouble of sneaking around as part of some elaborate plot to get him on board a cruise ship. Along with his *wife*."

Marshall almost didn't let it go. He got fixated on things, especially when he got jealous. After a moment of studying her, though, he nodded. Cassandra released a breath that she didn't realize she'd been holding. Then he asked, "But why didn't you just tell me?"

It was a good question. It may have been *the* question. "Because I was worried you'd behave just..." She leaned in. "...like..." And watched his eyes dip into the low front of her dress. "...this. You have a jealous streak, you know."

"Your fault."

"No," she shook her head. "You're the one who likes to dress me up. To show me off. So I'd say," she leaned back, "it's all yours."

Day six. Austin had made it to day six. Funny how the trip had gone from a literal pleasure cruise to something more akin to a vacation with the inlaws. At least that was an upside: he wouldn't have to suffer Faye's father's political evangelism.

It was funny. He felt both melancholy about the direction of his marriage, and also oddly at peace with it, too. His mother had died of cancer ten years before, and he remembered feeling like this when she'd finally passed on. He also remembered feeling guilty for feeling relieved. Same suite of emotions working through him now.

He spent his time doing the excursions that he'd wanted to do with Faye—the kinds of ones that she'd not been into at all. In St. Maarten, he'd gone snorkeling amongst sea turtles and stingrays. In Puerto Rico, he took the shuttle to El Yunque Rainforest and hiked out to a waterfall, where people were bathing in the basin.

And while he was on the ship, he decided not to hide. If he ran into Faye or Cassandra, so be it. Not that he participated in any of the hotwife festivities. He didn't attend the Leather & Lace Ball. He avoided anything with a platinum sign. Closest thing he got to was when he went to the spa on the fifth night and was pretty sure some people were having sex in the sauna. Sounded a little too hot for his comfort.

He did yoga in the morning on the Horizon Deck, even flirted a little with the cute instructor. He ate breakfast with everyone else, and behaved

like this was just a normal cruise, only he was all by himself.

That came to a head on the evening of the sixth day, though, when Austin was in the Explorer's Lounge, where he spent most evenings. He got over the slightly chintzy feel to the place, and it was usually pretty chill.

Not tonight, though. Tonight it was packed. With men. With the bulls. He recognized many of them—Joe Greene; the “Stunt Cock” guy from the other night, whose name was AJ; the lifeguard Mike Johnson. The guest relations manager, Inez, was one of the few women there, although she didn't seem to be present in any official capacity. She was there with the Thor look alike that he'd seen dancing with Cassandra so long ago, and they looked to be together.

“Hello, Mr. Reed,” she greeted him, friendly, professional. He was impressed that she remembered his name. “How's your new room?”

“It's been peaceful. Thanks again.”

“Of course. I'm sorry that this trip hasn't worked out for you. Hopefully it'll be okay once you're back on solid ground?”

“Thanks. And hopefully it will be.” He looked around. “So what's going on here?”

“Tonight's the Bull Auction,” she said, as if that explained it all. When he looked at her blankly, she explained. “Kind of a tradition at the end of these cruises. Couples—but mostly the husbands—will be able to bid on the ship's bulls for 24-hours of no questions asked fun. Jack here is one of those bulls.”

The Viking-looking guy grinned and extended his hand.”Jack.”

Austin shook. The guy had a grip like a pair of tire tongs. “Austin.”

Jack fairly beamed at Inez as he said to Austin, “Inez isn't one to exaggerate. These days do not disappoint.”

Austin took in the way Inez was holding Jack's muscled bicep. “Are you two...”

“Yeah, we are,” Inez said with a smile. “But obviously can't really be possessive when my boyfriend is an exotic dancer aboard a swinger cruise.”

“Fair enough.” This whole ship didn't cease to surprise him. “Well, good luck to you.”

“You should come and watch,” Inez said. “It's a fun spectacle, at the very least.”

Austin nodded. “So this is like the what? The waiting room?”

“We like to get together and have a few drinks before being paraded out like meat, yeah,” Jack said.

“Doesn’t that make you feel objectified?”

Inez laughed, covering her mouth. Jack clapped Austin on the back and grinned. “Buddy, that’s why I love my job so much. Objects have the best lives. No relationships. No hang ups. Just fun. And when it’s over and we disembark?”

“That’s where I come in,” Inez added. She slapped Jack on the butt. “Now go get your drink. I’ll take Austin in.”

Jack chuckled, looking between Inez and Austin. “Oh, I see what’s going on here.” Austin went hot under his collar. Jack thought Inez wanted to hook up with Austin, and while he had no intention of doing anything like that due to the complications in his life, it was flattering. “You have fun, you two. I know I will.”

Inez rolled her eyes. “Come on. Let the men go about doing their manly things.” She sidled up to Austin, linking her arm into his. In her heels she was actually taller than he and smelled fantastic. “You can get me a drink at the auction.”

CASSANDRA WORE A TIGHT, low-cut red dress that Marshall must have purchased for this very occasion. It was so short that it barely covered her ass, and she fairly poured out of the plunging neckline. Paired with sky-high heels and a delicate golden necklace that nestled between her breasts, she knew she looked flawless.

She was the woman that Marshall wanted to show off. With one arm wrapped around her from behind, and the other holding the bidding paddle, every bull who climbed up on that stage would be rooting for the couple to win. She was the perfect hotwife for her man.

“You look fucking incredible, honey,” he growled as they waited for the first of the bulls to be paraded out. “Every man in this room wants to fuck you.”

Cassandra blushed, feeling the rush of desire at his words. She looked around. The auction was in the Starlight Ballroom, where the rave had been held. It looked quite different without all the black lights and glow sticks.

The ceiling glittered with hundreds of lights, giving the room its name. Round high top tables were set up out on the dance floors, and caterers served champagne instead of shots. Funny how different something could look in a different context.

She spotted Austin standing towards the back, hidden by so many of the couples who were rapidly filling the venue. He was with a pretty blonde who wasn't his wife, and Cassandra's chest tightened in an unsettling burst of unfair jealousy before she realized that the woman was the concierge.

She hadn't seen him since the morning that he left her room. She wasn't sure how she'd react when she did. Now that he was there, chatting with the beautiful Inez, smiling, she found herself smiling, too. He looked happy.

A woman with dark red hair and a shimmering, silver cocktail dress emerged onto the raised platform that would serve as the stage. She lifted a microphone to her red painted lips and greeted the crowd in a crisp, British accent. "Good evenings, ladies and husbands. Most of you know me by now, but in case my voice isn't ringing any bells, I'm your cruise director, Felicity Jones, and I'm here to welcome you to our Bull Auction."

A murmur of excitement coursed through the crowd as Felicity Jones laid out the general rules of the auction. Each bull would come out, Felicity would give a little introduction, and the bidding would start. Highest bidder gets to spend the next day with the man. "Yes, ladies, that's a full twenty-four hours to do *whatever* you'd like with them."

"Or have them do whatever to us!" a woman from the back shouted.

"We won't ask, and you shouldn't tell, darling," Felicity said with a laugh of her own. "Now, let's begin, shall we? We'll start us off with Lucas, who hails all the way from Australia. Lucas, get on up here."

A fit, sandy-haired man with a playful smile hopped up on stage. If his hair had been shorter and his scruff longer, he could have been like a younger Austin. Cassandra wondered if there had been a time when her ex had sported that look.

"What do you think? Tempting?" Marshall whispered in her ear.

"They're all tempting," she said. "But let's see who else comes out."

Lucas was won by a tall, broad shouldered man and a strikingly beautiful Mediterranean brunette. The bull's easy-going grin only grew as he realized who he got to play with. Felicity moved on to the next bull, introducing a Spanish man who arrived in a slim suit... without a shirt on.

"This is Victor," Felicity said. "Victor, say hello."

“*Hola.*” He swept the room, his eyes landing right on Cassandra’s, and when they did, something inside of her stirred.

“Not him,” Marshall said as Felicity began the bidding. Cassandra recognized *that* tone. A man like Victor threatened her husband, which took him off the table.

The auction moved on. Cassandra recognized a number of the guys, including Paul from last night and Jack, a guy she’d danced with at some point. The couple from the hot tub won one of the bulls, a man older than Marshall, and she swore that she saw the woman whisper, “Daddy” to her partner.

All this possibility had Marshall nearly salivating. It was the kind of situation that normally would have gotten Cassandra going, too, and while the buzz and excitement of those around her was fun—as was watching each couple disappear with one—or sometimes *two*—guys to begin their night, she couldn’t help but feel like it was all just... performative.

A wave of empathy washed over her as she watched the bulls being auctioned off, one after another. These men were just sex toys, just like she was so often seen as nothing more than a sex toy. They were being bought and sold, their worth determined by how much pleasure they could provide to the wives they’d be servicing. That was the name of the game. That was why they came aboard, in the same way she had agreed to come aboard.

But as Marshall began to bid more enthusiastically, running up the auction prices before eventually backing off, Cassandra just wasn’t feeling it. When she turned her attention back to the stage, beside Felicity was a confident looking black guy named Joe. He’d hit on her a few nights back, she remembered, and would have been the man of the night had Austin not shown up.

“\$500,” Marshall said, raising his paddle. His arm tightened around Cassandra’s waist, and she could feel his enthusiasm in his touch. He was so excited, so eager to “win” this man for her.

And yet it just didn’t feel right. These men were human beings, with thoughts and feelings and desires. They weren’t just playthings for rich couples to use and discard.

But when Joe looked down at her from that stage, she realized that far from feeling like no more than a piece of meat, the bull looked even more eager than Marshall. He was okay with it. All of this was consensual.

Should have made it all better. All fine. But then she realized it wasn't these guys that she was having mixed feelings about. It was herself.

Off to their left, a white-haired gentleman bid \$750. Cassandra huffed a relieved breath.

"Marshall," she said over her shoulder. "I'm not sure about this."

"Sure you are," he said. Then, raising the paddle, he announced, "One thousand."

"One thousand to Mr. Cullen," Felicity said. "Do I hear twelve hundred?"

"Twelve hundred," someone announced from the back. Cassandra's heart jumped at his voice. It was Austin.

"Twelve hundred to Mr. Reed. How about fifteen hund—"

"Fifteen hundred," Marshall said before Felicity could finish. To Cassandra, Marshall said, "Looks like your ex is trying to steal away your plaything."

She cast a glance in Austin's direction, trying to figure out what his game was, and when their eyes met, she knew instinctively that he was doing this for her. Had he seen her distress? Or maybe he just didn't like the guy Marshall was bidding on.

"Two thousand." When Austin bid, he didn't take his eyes away from her.

She breathed in deeply, a smile tugging at the corners of her mouth. Marshall, still holding her against him, felt it. He followed her eyes. "Five thousand dollars," he said.

A loud murmur washed over the room. Even Felicity Jones's eyes went wide. "Well then, five thousand." She glanced at Joe. "Think you won a bet back there," she joked. "Five thousand to—"

"Six," Austin said. Another collective gasp, punctuated by some approving hoots and catcalls, erupted from the crowd. To Marshall, he said, loud enough for the entire room to hear, "And I'll keep going, if you want to play this game."

Marshall stared over at Austin, intense, unreadable, and ultimately cowed. "Fine." He put his paddle down. "Your boyfriend wins."

"He's not my boyfriend." Even as she said the words, she realized that she wished that he was.

After the room calmed down with that exceedingly high auction, Felicity introduced an Asian man named Kenji, who had to be a CrossFit

guy or something. Marshall was already raising his paddle before Felicity got to Kenji's bio.

"Twenty-five grand for this one and the next two." A ripple of excitement and shock went through the crowd. Marshall was staring at Austin, daring him to try anything. Even Austin looked stunned.

"Um, well, that's not quite how we do things here, but... that's very generous, Mr. Cullen. I think we can make an exception."

"Call it my contribution to such a memorable cruise," Marshall said.

Without protest from anyone in the audience, Marshall "won" the Japanese bull named Kenji, along with a black guy named Andre and a tattooed white guy named AJ.

Kenji came over, checking her out with an excited grin that once would have made her weak in the knees. Behind her, the other two followed. "I am honored," he said. He spoke with a British accent, rather than a Japanese one, with a deep and calming voice, and he spoke directly to Cassandra. Marshall may have done the bidding, but it was clear that this is where things shifted to the wives. "Want to go up to the Horizon Deck? They usually clear it out for the winners to go up and celebrate."

"That does sound nice," Cassandra said. "But would you excuse us? I'd like to have a chat with my husband first."

"Of course."

Marshall pulled out his keycard and handed it to Kenji. "Here, why don't you three go back to the cabin. We'll be along shortly." He gave them their room number.

Kenji glanced between the two of them, clearly sensing the underlying tension. Then, as if realizing that it wasn't really his place, he simply shrugged, held up the keycard as if it were part of some sort of mock salute, and the three guys ambled off.

"What's this all about, Cassie?"

Behind them, the auction droned on. "*Okay, husbands, can I get five hundred? Bargain after that last round...*"

"Let's go outside," Cassandra said. "I need some air."

Clouds had been rolling in since late afternoon, and it had begun to drizzle by the time they got outside. All of which seemed strangely fitting in light of both Cassandra's feelings and the conversation that she knew wouldn't be easy, but could clearly no longer be put off.

With a deep breath, she began.

“Marshall, I don’t want this.”

He looked at her, not quite surprised, but more than a little annoyed. “What are you talking about? This is what we want. What we came here for. To have fun. To have adventures. To have crazy sex.”

Cassandra shook her head. “No, Marshall. That’s what *you* want.”

“Okay. So what is it that you want?” He was asking the right question, but not in the right way.

“I want to be loved and respected, not used and controlled.”

Marshall's face darkened. “Oh, come *on*, Cassie. Don’t rewrite history here. We both know you enjoy the fuck out of being used and controlled.”

“Sure I do, but I still need the love and the respect. I once had that from you, but lately... lately I’m not so sure.”

Marshall stepped up to her, running his hands up and down along her upper arms. “Honey, babydoll, I *do* love you. How could you even think that I don’t? And of course I respect you. You’re my princess.”

“And that’s just it. I don’t want to be your ‘princess’. Do you have any idea how condescending that is?”

“I don’t get it.”

And that was it. That was the heart of the matter. Marshall *didn’t* get it. He could never get it. When he looked at his wife, he always seemed to see her as just another entry in his portfolio. When his company went public and they could afford nicer things, he made sure to dress her up, to get her the best personal trainers, the best stylists. As their wealth grew and his portfolio got stronger, so did his expectations for his sexy wife.

Cassandra had no doubt that Marshall loved her. But lately it sure seemed as if her husband loved her the way he loved his classic Superleggera, acquired shortly after his IPO took flight, or that new Buggati he’d had delivered just before they left for this cruise.

Yes, to him she was a treasured *possession*, which meant he sure as hell didn’t look at her the way that she wanted to be looked at. The way *Austin* had looked at her the other night, or the way Heather looked at Paul, or any of those couples gazed at each other tonight. Those wives weren’t possessions. With someone like Austin, she never would be a possession, nor a princess... but maybe, just maybe, she could be his queen.

“You don’t get it, no,” she said sadly. “But I think that finally, *finally*, I do.”

“Okay.” The rain poured down around them, warm and tropical and cleansing. “Can we go back to the cabin now? I’ve got \$25,000 ready to show you how much I love you.”

“I’m not going there or anywhere with *you*.”

Marshall blinked. “Don’t be silly, of course you are.”

“No.” Cassandra shook her head, her hair wet and sticking to her neck now. “I’m not.”

“Then what the fuck am I going to do with three well-hung guys?”

She shrugged. “You’re a clever guy. I’m sure you’ll figure something out.”

“Cute. You’ve had your fun. Now, come on.” He reached for her arm, no longer content with just verbal commands. Cassandra wasn’t sure who was more surprised, her husband or herself, when she jerked her arm free of his grip and took several steps back from him.

“*Cassandra*,” Marshall hissed, his eyes narrowed to slits, his tone menacing in a way she had never before heard from him. “How *dare* you defy me?!”

She felt that in the pit of her stomach. Swallowing hard and drawing herself up to her full height, she lifted her chin, and said, “Don’t talk to me that way, Marshall. You’re not a king, and I’m not your dress-up doll. Have you forgotten that when I met you, you drove a *Corolla*?”

“Enough of these games,” he spat. “You’re coming back—”

“No she’s not.” A man’s voice cut through the night and the rain and the sound of the ocean. Footsteps along the wooden decking preceded Austin, stepping into the scene.

“Oh, sure. The *boyfriend*,” Marshall rolled his eyes and directed his next words at Austin. “*You* stay out of this.”

“Like hell I will.”

”This is none of your business!” Marshall barked.

“You know the rules,” Austin replied calmly. Cassandra recalled his manner, how diffident he had been, even just a few short days before, when they had reconnected at the beginning of this cruise. The intervening week sure seemed to have worked some magic on her ex-boyfriend. “I believe Felicity said something along the lines of consent being mandatory?”

“She is my *wife*.” Marshall took a step in Cassandra’s direction, but Austin was there, a hand on his chest, his face close to Marshall’s. Cassandra usually never went in for the white knight thing, but in that

moment, she could practically see the moonlight glinting off of Austin's shining armor, and she was grateful.

"You seem to think that word has permanence," Austin said. "But it's just a word, utterly meaningless unless you put the work in. Trust me, I should know."

Marshall backed away, but didn't leave. Not yet. A crowd had begun to gather at both ends of the deck. Felicity Jones was there, as was the captain. Marshall gave them a wary look before focusing back on Cassandra, eyes wide, brows raised. *Come*, that look said. He might as well have been commanding a dog to heel.

"I'm not going with you," Cassandra said. "You can stop waiting."

Marshall started to say something, glanced again at Austin, at the crowd one more time, and stalked away. Immediately, Cassandra sagged, and Austin was there to catch her.

"That was brave," he murmured into her hair.

"Thank you," she said back. "You didn't need to do that."

"No, but I *wanted* to. There was no way I could stand by and let him talk to you like that."

Without thought, she took him into her arms and kissed him. Their clothes were soaked. The rain had picked up. Neither of them even noticed. All that mattered was this kiss, this embrace, this stop on their long and winding journey.

"Want to get out of here?" Austin asked. He was back to being the shy guy she remembered.

"Well," she said with a smile that she couldn't shake even if she wanted to, "all the eligible bulls on this ship are now literally taken, so I guess I'm stuck with you."

Cassandra's kiss was so energetic, and so surprising, that she nearly knocked Austin down. He planted his feet and braced himself against her body, wrapping his arms around her narrow waist and flaring hips. It *did* knock the adrenaline out of him. Had he really stepped up into another man's face? He'd never done that before.

She didn't step away when the kiss broke, but merely pulled back enough to meet his gaze and smile. It was raining. He hadn't even noticed that until he saw how wet her hair was, curling in the dampness.

He looked into her eyes, smiling and filled with light. Eyes that he felt he could come back to again and again for the rest of his life. "Want to get out of here?"

Okay, so maybe the adrenaline wasn't *entirely* gone.

"Well, all the eligible bulls on this ship are now literally taken, so I guess I'm stuck with you."

Austin laughed. "I don't ever want you to feel stuck with me."

"God, you're making me want to kiss you again." She squeezed his arms.

"I won't stop you."

So they kissed again, deeper this time, hands roaming their wet bodies, even as the rain seemed to only get heavier and heavier around them.

A woman cleared her throat, and they broke their kiss. There stood Inez, holding an umbrella to keep the rain off of her dress, and beside her stood

Joe Greene. “Mr. Reed, Mrs. Cullen,” she said in that sexy, accented voice of hers. She didn’t say anything specifically about their pairing, but she seemed to approve of it. “I believe that you’ve paid for the services of this man.”

When Joe saw who his highest bidder was, he seemed surprised. “I know you.” He looked at Cassandra, and further recognition crossed his face. “You stole her away from me the other night. You two together?”

“No—” Austin began, at the same time Cassandra said, “Yes.”

They turned and laughed together. Austin said, “You don’t remember the first night, when you told me to wait at the bar as you fucked my wife back in our cabin?”

Joe looked Cassandra up and down, rubbing his chin as he did so. “I would have remembered fucking her, believe me.”

The man didn’t even remember the cuckold exchange that had kicked this whole thing off for Austin. That was funny to him, another reminder that the world definitely didn’t revolve around him. It didn’t revolve around any of them.

“So I have twenty-four hours and you have to do whatever I tell you to do?” Austin asked.

“Within reason,” Inez responded. “This is still a consensual cruise, but Joe here doesn’t have many limits.”

The way those two exchanged a smile gave Austin the impression that there was something there. He glanced at Cassandra, his brows up. *What do you want to do?*

She hadn’t broken contact with him since their kiss, still pressed against his body, still snuggling into his arms. She was looking towards *him* to make the decision, Austin realized. It was a foreign concept for him. Faye would already be halfway back to their cabin.

Without saying a word aloud, he changed his expression ever so slightly. *You’d be okay with this?*

He caught the way her chest drew in and her eyes dilated just so. He definitely caught her subtle nod. Two epiphanies hit him: she cared enough to really *see* him, and she really was a hotwife. She may have done a lot for her husband’s pleasure, but it wasn’t for him alone.

“Okay, Joe,” Austin said, never releasing Cassandra from his arms. “You think you can make Cass here scream your name as you make her come over and over again?”

“I’ve been known to do that,” Joe said, completely unironically. Austin almost laughed. Sometimes it was good to be the nondescript guy.

“Good, because I’d really like to watch that.”

Cassandra shivered against him, and he knew that he’d made the right decision.

“OH... Fuck... I feel so... Uh! So full...” Cassandra rode Joe cowgirl-style, bouncing her round ass up and down on his massive, black cock as her DD tits jiggled. She leaned forward, planting her hands on his shoulders, her nails biting into his flesh, as she continued to rut her hips. “Fuck me... harder!”

Austin watched from a chair beside the bed, his dick in his hand, his heart in his throat. But he didn’t feel like an outsider. He didn’t feel like a third wheel. Not with Cassandra and the way she kept looking over at him and smiling, as if confirming to herself that he was still there.

“Ah! Ah! AH! He feels good, baby. He feels so fucking big... in... inside me...”

“Make her come,” Austin said. “Make her scream your name.”

Joe grabbed Cassandra’s hips and thrust up into her, fucking her harder, faster, taking control of her body in the way that Austin realized she would always need.

“Oh my god! Yes! Austin! Watch me! Watch me take this big black cock!”

Austin stroked himself faster as Cassandra writhed on top of Joe. She arched back. Her hair had never dried from the rain, and now was dappled with sweat. She cupped her full tits in her hands, pinching her nipples, and screamed. Joe helped things along, rubbing her pussy and grunting with exertion as he brought Cassandra closer and closer to orgasm.

“Say it,” Joe groaned. “Say my name.”

“Fuck me! Fuck me, Joe! Joe! AGGGHHH! YESSSSSSS!!! JOE!”

Cassandra threw her head back and came hard, her pussy spasming and gushing around Joe’s throbbing cock. “Don’t come, Joe. Not yet,” Austin said. “We’re not done yet.”

“I’m good to go all night, boss man.”

Cassandra collapsed onto him, panting hard, fighting to catch her breath as her bull looked to Austin for orders. This was all new to Austin, but he didn't hate it. A part of him actually wanted to send the bull away with blue balls.

"Mmm..." Cassandra pushed her damp hair from her face and looked over at Austin, her head resting on another man's chest. "Did you like watching that, baby?"

Austin nodded. He released his rock-hard cock and crawled over to her on the bed. She lifted up off of Joe enough to meet him for a wet, playful kiss. It was funny, but he'd bid on Joe Greene so that the man *wouldn't* fuck Cassandra, and yet here they were. "I *loved* watching you."

"I loved you watching, too. More than you know."

Austin tipped his head back and forth. "I may have a pretty good idea."

"Thank you, Austin," she said, smiling at him, her eyes shining with warmth and tenderness. His heart swelled. "Thank you for being here for me, for seeing me for who I really am."

"I do like looking at you," he said.

"Oh, you." She giggled. Leaning in as if sharing a secret, she whispered, "He's still hard."

"I heard that he's good to go all night."

She gently stroked Austin's cheek. "Think we should test it out?"

"I'm up for trying," he said.

"Me too," Joe added.

"Well, boys, let's get back to it!"

HOURS LATER CASSANDRA had finally collapsed onto her back, completely, utterly, profoundly fucked out. She'd had a lot of sex over the years, but it had never been like this. Joe Greene, the now-tamed bull, really was a good lay. That was part of it. Most of it, however, was Austin.

She wasn't performing for Austin. She wasn't just playing a role for him, the way she realized she'd been doing for Marshall. Maybe it hadn't started that way with him, so long ago, but that was certainly where things were now.

With Austin, their connection felt genuine. The bull may have been there between them, fucking her, making her come, making her scream so hard that her throat was raw, but the real connection was what she had for Austin.

“Thank you for tonight,” she murmured. They’d sent Joe away, back to his room, just so that they could snuggle. This was the part of the night when Marshall would climb onto her and “reclaim” her as if she was a book recently returned. Neither of them had the energy for that, yet lying there, listening to Austin’s heartbeat, she felt like she’d finally been successfully returned to her rightful place.

“I should be the one thanking you.” He kissed the top of her head.

“How about we just thank each other equally.”

Austin chuckled. “I like that.” He brushed his fingers through her hair. “You know that when I ‘won’ Joe, I was doing it because I hated the idea of that guy cucking me twice.”

“You’re not a cuck,” she said.

“Maybe I’m not. I don’t know. There are aspects of it that I like. I... I like watching. I *really* liked watching you.”

“Same. One thing that Marshall got right about me, it’s that I like being used. I like to give up control.”

“Sounds like the opposite of Faye. She *hates* giving that up.”

Cassandra nodded. “Our spouses sound pretty similar. Not that they are. It’s how we got here that defines us.”

“I like being here,” Austin said, hugging her to him. “And I even like how we got here, as weird and winding as it was.”

“Certainly has helped put things in perspective.” She formulated her thoughts in the quiet of the room. When she spoke, her voice was soft. “You know, I can admit that there’s something exciting about being wanted—about feeling so desirable and sexy. But at the same time, it can be... overwhelming. Exhausting, even. Always being on display, always performing for Marshall's benefit.”

Austin was quiet, and for a moment, Cassandra was pretty sure that he’d fallen asleep. That was fine. The revelation was meant as much for herself as it was to be shared. But when he did respond, her heart sang with joy. To be *heard*.

“You shouldn’t need to perform for any man, Cass. You should be able to be your genuine self.”

“I’m not even sure what my genuine self is anymore. I’ve molded myself into Marshall’s plaything.”

Austin shifted so that they could lie side-by-side in bed, facing one another, seeing one another in the dark. “Maybe. I used to think that, too. Like, Faye made me a cuckold. I’m really just doing it for her. But watching you tonight with Joe made me realize that while Faye may have forced me to confront that aspect of myself, he has always been there.”

“So you’re saying that deep down, I really am a bimbo fuckslut?”

It was a joke, but she saw how bad it made Austin feel. “No, that’s not—”

“It’s okay, I know, I know. You’re just saying that we’re more complex than labels.”

“Yes. And I like watching you fuck other men.”

Cassandra shifted in and rubbed her nose against his. “And I like fucking other men...” She kissed him softly. “...while you watch.”

“This was *not* the way I thought this cruise would go,” Austin said. “But I am so glad that I came aboard.”

Day seven of the cruise aboard the Princess of Adventure dawned as a fresh start for both Austin and Cassandra. Things were no more certain than they were the day before—if anything, the future was even more blurry. A marriage built over years doesn't end after a few days aboard a hotwife cruise, and there would be many hard conversations to be had in the future.

But they did have one more day at sea, and one more night, before they got back to Miami and reality and all the consequences of this trip. And neither of them could avoid their spouses entirely.

Cassandra confronted hers head on, returning to her suite mid-morning and wondering what she'd find. There was no sign of the three guys that Marshall had purchased, although her husband was there, sitting on the balcony, staring out at the horizon.

"You're back," he said without looking at her.

"I'm here to get my things."

"You staying with *him* now?"

"I am."

Marshall finally turned to her. He looked exhausted, with bags under his eyes and unshaved whiskers on his face. "You know you're mine, right? You made a commitment. We're married."

"I did make a commitment. But so did you. I think we've lost sight of that over the years. Marriage isn't supposed to feel like a straight jacket. It's

not a suicide pact—”

“‘Til death do us part.’”

“We also promised to be true to one another in good times and bad. I’m being true to you now, Marsh. I can’t do this anymore.”

“So that’s it? You’re just going to run off with your ex-boyfriend and ride off into the sunset or whatever? What about the life we have? The lifestyle? He cannot support you the way I can—”

“I don’t *want* to be supported. I want to support myself, Marshall. That’s what you’re not getting.” She pinched the bridge of her nose. “I don’t know if I’ll end up with Austin. You’re completely missing the point.”

“So tell me, my bimbo fuckdoll, what am I missing?”

Cassandra knew those words so well. Always designed to undermine her and remind her of her secondary place in their narcissistic sham of a marriage. It was a good reminder that she was making the right choice.

“You know the sad thing? Deep down, you and I both know I’m neither of those things. Not really.”

“You were always so thin-skinned.”

She shook her head. “My reaction is actually irrelevant. After all, the wonderful thing about a ‘fuckdoll’ for someone with your outlook is that a fuckdoll is a possession, first and foremost. Nothing about me: not my smarts, soul, inventiveness, compassion, feelings, desires, not one thing requires the tiniest scintilla of respect from you.”

Marshall tried to respond, but she kept going, finishing her thought. “And by playing along, by not rocking the boat, I have let you down as a wife and partner. By indulging you in this I feel I may have helped stunt your growth.”

“Seems like a lot of words to justify giving up the life that I’ve given you.”

Cassandra took a deep breath and shrugged. This wouldn’t be their last conversation but it was going to have to be their last on this trip. “Sure, if that’s your takeaway. I’m just saying that I’m ready to try something new. Something entirely for myself.”

AUSTIN FOUND Faye eating alone in the cafeteria. She looked lost in thought, and for a moment he saw the woman that he'd fallen for—a woman constantly at war with the world.

"Hey," he said, sitting down across from her.

She blinked, refocusing, and that melancholy expression fell away. "Well look who it is, my long lost husband."

"Faye..."

"You know that this cruise is focused on couples, right? And this specific voyage is for couples in the hotwife and swinging lifestyle?"

"That's my understanding, too."

"Then what the fuck happened, Austin? I wanted to make some memories, you and me."

"Well, we certainly made some of those. Just not the kind you were probably hoping for."

"Oh, my memories will be particularly spicy."

Austin chuckled. "Even now, you can't help yourself, can you?"

"You've changed. Is that because of *her*?" Faye practically spat the word "her."

"Not just because of her. You played a part, too." Looking around at all the other couples enjoying one another on their last day at sea, he added, "So did this cruise. But honestly? I think we both know that this has been coming for a long time."

Faye didn't look happy, but if he thought about it, Austin wasn't sure he could honestly recall the last time she did look truly happy.

Unlike before, she'd had a few days to sit with it, and seemed resigned to their fate. "It's going to be weird back home. And I'm keeping the house."

"That's fine. You picked it anyway."

"This is really happening?" She looked sad, but also, like him, unburdened.

"Yeah. But I do have a parting gift."

"Austin..."

"Just a little something I picked up last night." He nodded, and Joe walked over from where he'd been waiting by the stairs. Looking at his watch, he said, "You get him until about 9 tonight. After that, it's up to you to keep him."

Austin walked away with a smile.

CASSANDRA AND AUSTIN had dinner together at the Nautical Nook Bar on the evening of their last day on the cruise. Unlike the first night, by day seven, it was almost empty. Everyone on the ship seemed worn out, like travelers suffering from jetlag.

Cassandra looked wiped, too, but she was still smiling. That was her thing. She was always smiling.

“How did your conversation go?” he asked her.

“About as well as I expected it would. Yours?”

“Surprisingly okay, actually. I think Faye’s going to be happier this way.”

Cassandra chuckled. “Marshall would have been fine continuing with our dynamic forever.”

“But not you.”

“No, not me. I’ll be the first to admit that I’m a pleaser and a submissive, and get joy from that. Marshall figured that out about me early on, and used it to...”

“Exploit you?”

She didn’t immediately agree with the assessment. “That may be too harsh a word, but yeah, he took advantage. I’m also an exhibitionist, right? It’s fun to perform. It’s fun to be looked at. I didn’t get my tits done just for Marshall, although he was a driving force behind it, and his Dom kink definitely scratched an itch for me.”

Austin nodded, absorbing it.

“I liked parts of what we had, enough so that I was willing to work with it. I liked the relationship—most of it—just not the man. And I’ve never been one for confrontation.”

“Guess you got over that.”

“With your help.” She took his hand into hers. They still wore their rings, and Austin could almost imagine they were a couple.

“You know I can’t be a Dom for you, right? I may have changed, and we’re all capable of it, but that would be pretty extreme.”

“And you don’t need to be. You’re something better.” They laced their fingers together. “You’re my equal, and I have a good feeling that you’d be open to me finding my sub mode in other places.”

Austin's cock thickened at the idea. Joe last night was just a taste of what they could have. "Yes, I'm a very open person." He leaned across the table and kissed her. "So are we going to try and make this thing happen?"

She looked at him, her brow furrowed. "Isn't that what we're currently doing?"

They spent the rest of dinner catching up on the years that they'd spent apart. And there was so much to catch up on. Austin talked about how he hiked the Pacific Crest Trail. She told him about what it was like right after Marshall's IPO, when they realized they had more money than they ever thought possible. Or about Marshall's health scare, the thing that made them both realize how short life could be, and how important it was to live it to its fullest.

"Maybe not *fullest*, I'm realizing. It's easy to get caught up in it all and take things too far."

"I'll drink to that."

As they were leaving, they happened to run into one of the three bulls from the auction last night, the Japanese guy with the British accent. "You two enjoying your last night?" Kenji said.

Cassandra squeezed Austin's arm. "We are," she said.

Austin nodded. "Sorry for stealing our entertainment last night."

Kenji dismissed the apology. "You've got it backwards. We were the entertainment. And in any case, don't worry. Plenty of hotwives out there whose husbands didn't participate in the auction."

"You do these often?"

"The cruises? A few times. There are other events, but this one's probably the most elaborate." He chuckled. "I just like banging hot chicks, man."

"Seems like a good fit then," Austin chuckled.

To Cassandra, Kenji said, "It looks like you've got your own thing, but just so you're aware, you've still got a couple hours left." He gestured towards the central, circular bar, where the other two bulls were sitting, having a beer. Austin was surprised to see that one of them—the other white guy—was the same man who'd fucked Faye back on day two—the "Stunt Cock.". What a small world. "And we're bought and paid for."

Austin and Cassandra shared a glance that said, *Last night in paradise*. And they nodded together. "Hopefully one of you has a bigger room."

"Don't worry. We've got you covered."

Cassandra had been with a group of men two other times in her life, both set up by Marshall. The first had happened “organically,” although she later learned that Marshall had spoken with the men ahead of time. The second was a “gift” to her for their tenth anniversary—five black men and an 8 ball of coke. This was Marshall’s form of romance.

Both experiences had been incredibly hot—true adventures. She might have been performing for Marshall, but she also loved having all those men around her, their cocks hard for her, everyone there to please and be pleased. It wasn’t something she wanted very often, and the second time, she’d had to fight back a fair amount of shame over some of what she’d done, and yet she couldn’t deny that as good times went, it was a memorable one.

But Cassandra had never felt the kind of buzz that came over her as Kenji led them along the corridors of the upper deck, toward a private area aboard the ship appropriately called the Captain’s Suite. “Are you sure this is okay?” Austin asked, sounding just as nervous as she felt.

“We were actually going to come up here in a few. There’s always a wild party up here on the last night. You should stick around... after.”

After she gets fucked hard by three bulls and her... boyfriend? Austin thought. Is that what she was calling him now?

They arrived at a pair of double doors before she could respond. A brass plaque read: The Captain’s Suite. Kenji turned back and grinned. “Ready?”

Cassandra and Austin looked at one another, doing that thing that seemed to come so naturally to them: silent communication. *Ready? Yes. Let's do this.*

She laced her fingers into his and nodded. "Yes."

Kenji knocked, and a moment later, the captain himself opened the door. Captain Carlos Rodriguez was a good looking older gentleman, his thick dark hair and beard speckled with gray, giving him a debonair look. She'd heard him speak countless times over the PA, but had only seen him at a distance.

"Well, hello there," he said, his voice carrying only the hint of a South American accent. "Cassandra, right?"

"That's right. You know me?"

"We were concerned by that scene last night. Inez briefed me." He turned to Austin. "But it seems all is well now. Come. I don't mean to keep you waiting in the hall." He stepped aside, and they entered one of the most opulent spaces in a ship filled with them.

The Captain's Suite was like the bridge of a ship, if that bridge had been converted into a swanky bar. Floor-to-ceiling windows formed the front half of the vast space, overlooking Mermaid's Cove Pool on one side, and the Horizon Deck on the other.

Inside were all the trappings of a porn shoot—a massive sectional, a king-sized bed draped in black satin sheets that shimmered beneath a crystal chandelier. And at the center of the room bubbled a jacuzzi, a set piece to a night of decadence.

Felicity Jones, the cruise director and MC from last night, was submerged beneath the bubbles, her dark red hair tied up in a bun and her full breasts just barely obscured beneath the jacuzzi froth. "I'm so happy that you two found one another," she said, her posh British accent so similar to, and yet so different from Kenji's distinctive West Country cant. She raised a flute of champagne to them and sipped. "I try to make it a point never to gossip about our guests, but let's just say I think you two will be better off after this trip."

Captain Rodriguez walked over to Felicity, untied his robe, and dropped it around his ankles. He was butt naked, and despite what was about to happen, Cassandra still found herself blushing at the sight of the older man's muscular buttocks.

“Get yourselves a drink,” he said as he lowered himself into the hot water. “And join us in the hot tub once you’re done.”

Cassandra stared as Felicity floated over to the captain and climbed into his lap. “We can stay and watch if you’d like that,” Kenji said.

“Um, no...” She shook her head. “I just... isn’t that kind of inappropriate for them to be...?”

Andre chuckled. “They are consenting adults.”

“And he may be the captain,” Kenji added. “But he’s not her superior.”

“Right.” Cassandra took a deep breath and squeezed Austin’s hand. “No drinks. I want to be sober for this.”

“As the lady wishes.”

The three bulls led Cassandra and Austin into one of the two bedrooms that were built off of the Captain’s Suite. “This will be a little more private. That room won’t be so empty by the time we’re done.”

While this room may have been more private, it was still larger than the suite that she and Marshall had shared, with the same floor-to-ceiling windows. The sky had cleared up, and the stars were out now.

Cassandra took a deep breath, turned to Austin, and pulled him close. “We don’t have to do this,” she whispered.

He grinned. “I was going to say the same thing.”

“Do you want to?” She sidled closer.

“Do you?”

Cassandra giggled. “If this is going to work, one of us needs to be a little more assertive.”

“Fine. Yes. I want to watch you. I want to see these guys ignite your world.”

Cassandra’s lips parted as a rush of excitement raced through her. She searched his face, his eyes, his soul, for some hesitation. All she found was genuine excitement—for her to have fun, for her to enjoy for her own sake. She pulled him close and kissed him hard, sinking her tongue down his throat in her eagerness.

Then, stepping back, she turned to Kenji and Andre and AJ. “Come on, boys. Show me what you can do.”

They moved in around her, tall, broad, muscular. So much manliness. She felt herself swoon. Kenji was there first, kissing her lips and running his hands over her body, her breasts. Andre moved in behind her, his lips feeling like fire as he trailed kisses down her neck and out her shoulder. He

pushed the strap of her dress off, kissing the exposed skin. AJ just watched, slowly unbuttoning his shirt.

She took turns kissing them as they stripped, as they stripped her, as they got her worked up. "Love the tan lines," Andre said. Over the course of this trip, she'd sunned exclusively in a thong for this specific reaction.

"I've always been a thong girl," she said. "Austin knows."

Even back in her more "innocent" days, she liked how sexy they made her feel. Austin nodded, remembering.

Naked, she sank down to her knees. Her breath caught again as she looked up at the three hot men surrounding her, their big, hard dicks bobbing in her face. She glanced over at Austin, seated in a nearby chair, and felt a delicious thrill of excitement crackle along the connection between them as their eyes met.

Turning back to her bulls, she grinned. "Mmm, you boys are so big and stiff, and all for me! Can't wait to feel all that hard flesh inside of me."

Leaning forward, she took Andre's black dick into her mouth first, swirling her tongue around the head as she sucked him slowly. With her free hands, she reached up and started to stroke Kenji and AJ, her small hands barely able to fully wrap around their thick shafts.

At first she took turns with them, guiding the pace. But these were bulls, alphas, and they knew a beta when they saw one. It was Kenji who cupped her chin, pulled her off of Andre, and guided her mouth to his dick. That stereotype about Asian men being smaller than average was completely busted by what this man was packing.

"Mmmph," she moaned as he stuffed his cock down her throat. When he released her, letting her gasp for air, she only stared up at him and said, "Yes, just like that. Fuck my mouth, baby!"

The blowbang grew wilder, the men pawing at her face and hair, fucking her face more roughly. Her eyes watered as she gagged and slurped around their dicks, but fuck was she wet. And every time she looked over at Austin, she felt a jolt of delight that went straight to her core.

Pulling back from AJ, strings of saliva still connecting her lips with his shaft, she looked up at her three men. "Who wants to fuck me first? I need a big, hard cock in my tight pussy. Right now."

Cassandra moaned as Kenji and AJ each grabbed one of her arms, pulling her to her feet. They guided her over to the bed, pushing her down onto her hands and knees. She looked at Austin first, smiling at him as he

smiled back. It wasn't the intense look of pain that Marshall always wore. Somewhere, in the back of her head, she thought it was funny that Austin was thought of as the cuck, when it was Marshall who always seemed to self-flagellate.

Weight on the bed behind her blasted away any thought of her husband. She glanced back at them over her shoulder. "Come on, boys. Don't keep a girl waiting."

It was AJ, the jacked white guy with a tattoo sleeve of a dragon. His strong hands grabbed her by the hips. A moment later, his thick cock pressed against her dripping wet entrance. She gasped as he drove into her, stretching her in the best possible way.

"Fuck, you're wet!" AJ said with a chuckle.

"And you're so—BIG!"

He didn't wait for her to get used to him. She didn't need it. Holding her hips in place, he started slamming home. Her eyes rolled back into her head as an orgasm boiled up through her body. "Ohhh! Oh fuck!"

Through the haze, she felt the other men around her, surrounding her, touching her, playing with her. Someone pushed a cock against her lips. Kenji. She opened her mouth to it, taking it all the way into her throat. Hands caressed her tits, squeezing, pinching. Their hands were rough, their touch demanding in all of the best ways.

"Oh my God... yes!" she cried when she wasn't sucking a cock. She was at the center of their worlds. She was at the center of *his* world.

Austin sat there through it all, watching from his chair, his blue eyes darkened with lust. He made her feel beautiful, desired, even through this debaucherous encounter, even as AJ grunted hard, slamming into her one last time and exploded deep inside of her.

Cassandra lost it, screaming in ecstasy, her pussy clamping down around his shaft as she joined him. Her juices gushed out around him. "Oh, fuck," she said hoarsely.

Rolling onto her back, she looked up at the other men. "Mmmm... that was amazing. Who's next?"

Before either of them could answer, she sat up and took Kenji's cock back into her mouth, sucking him eagerly as she stroked Andre's shaft with her hand. "You know what? I want you both. At the same time. Inside of me."

The guys grinned. "We can do that," Andre said.

Kenji nodded. "As the lady wishes."

Austin was all smiles when she looked over. "Would you like to see that?" she asked.

"I cannot wait."

A few nights back, during that wild threesome with Cassandra and Marshall, Austin had been a participant. It was one of the most amazing nights of his life. This one topped it, and all he did was sit and watch.

But he wasn't just a passenger. This wasn't live porn. Cassandra made him feel included in a way that Faye never did—even when he *was* allowed to watch. Cass kept looking over at him, checking in with him, making sure that he was okay. And he was. He was better than okay.

"Would you like to see that?" she asked.

Did he want to see these three studs take Cassandra to a place of pure and unadulterated pleasure? "I cannot wait."

Kenji arranged himself on his back, dick straight up, as AJ fished out some lube from a bowl beside the bed. He tossed it to Kenji, who greased up his pole as Cassandra threw her leg over his body, facing away.

"Ready?" Kenji asked as she reached down between her legs and guided him against her ass.

"So ready," she hissed, taking the tip of his L.O.N.G.-sized cock into her ass. "Oh god... oh fuck... so... so full..."

"Just relax," Kenji said, letting her sink down onto him, getting used to his size.

Austin watched, mesmerized at the sight. Cassandra was so experienced. She'd come so far from their dating days, and he couldn't wait to learn about all the crazy things that she did. If he could get any harder, he would have. But that was definitely not possible. Not when Andre stepped up, black cock in hand, and pressed it against Cassandra's bald gash.

Cassandra moaned as the second man sank into her, arching back and bracing herself on the prone man beneath her. "Fuck me..." she gasped, her voice raw. "Fuck me hard..."

The bulls shared a look among themselves, nodded to one another, and did as they were told.

"OH! YES!"

Austin had watched her get DP'ed the other night, but things were so much different when he wasn't tangled in the midst of it. He'd enjoyed the

other night a lot, but this was better. He couldn't explain it, but it was the difference between trying to play soccer, and watching a professional play soccer.

These three guys were professionals, and he loved the things that they did to Cassandra.

"Uh! Uh! Yes! Fuck! Yes!" She had begun to give voice to a string of staccato moans and profanities. She gripped the sheets on either side of her, hanging on for dear life as the two guys bounced their dicks inside of her. Austin watched, stroking his own, careful not to pop himself.

When AJ approached her, his dick once again thick and at her eye level, it was like she sensed him. She reached out, wrapped her hand around him, and took him into her mouth. Austin watched as his cockhead bulged against her cheek and her saliva drooled down his shaft. He had to take his hand off his dick entirely and force his heart to slow down.

"Fuck, you guys," she gasped, popping off of AJ. "You are *huge*."

"Well, we *are* in a club designed for hung gentlemen."

"I don't want gentlemen right now," she almost giggled. She glanced over at Austin and winked. "I want you to make me your little slut while he watches."

Her eyes glimmered. Austin's heart swelled. He blew her a kiss.

And then her bulls truly took over. Any previously shown restraint was gone. Kenji held her hips in place as he rammed his dick up into her ass. Andre followed his rhythm, plunging down into her, his cock a blur. AJ stuffed her throat, plugging her up completely, airtight and suffocating.

AJ pulled out before she passed out, and for a second, Austin was pretty sure that she had. Her eyes were squeezed shut, her mouth remained parted in a silent scream. Then her jaw clenched and she rocked back, thrusting her tits high, and the grunting came.

"OH FUCK! YES! I'M FUCKING THERE!"

They didn't relent. Andre pounded her until he exploded inside of her, his come joining AJ's. When he pulled out, AJ was back, taking his place, making sure to keep her stuffed. One orgasm rolled into the next, her moans unintelligible.

Austin climbed out of his chair and up onto the bed. She seemed to sense his presence, opening her eyes and reaching out to him as the two men worked her holes. She squeezed his hand, painfully tight, and yanked him down into a fiery kiss.

Kenji finally relented, his hot seed exploding into her ass. She couldn't maintain the kiss, breaking away, rocking her head back and coming hard again. Austin brushed her damp locks across her sweat-dappled forehead and watched as she came yet again. It was beautiful. *She* was beautiful.

Coming down, she collapsed onto the bed, panting hard and trembling, completely spent. Kenji climbed out from under her and clapped his hands together as if to say, *Well, that was a job well done.*

After taking a moment to get her breathing under control, followed by several, deep, cleansing breaths to help slow her galloping heart rate, Cassandra sat up on the bed, her body still trembling from the intense experience. "Thank you so much, guys. That was absolutely amazing."

"Fuck yeah, it was," AJ enthused. The others agreed.

"I'm glad that we got to fulfill our contract from last night," Kenji added. The guys began to dress.

"Of course. Very important to fulfill contracts," Cassandra said in faux seriousness.

Andre pulled his shirt on. "We are men of our word."

"Gentlemen, right?" Cassandra laughed.

"So they say."

Cassandra and Austin watched the men leave before she rolled over to look at him. "So, did you enjoy the show?"

He kissed her forehead, tasting her sweat. "More than anything I've ever watched before."

"We should probably get out of here. I have a feeling that we were just the opening act for the Captain's Suite."

Austin nodded. "You okay coming back to my little cabin?"

She leaned close, buried her face in his neck. "I'm okay going anywhere with you."

“Is it premature to tell you that I love you?”

It was the morning of the final day of the ship. They’d be docking in Miami soon, and Cassandra and Austin had spent most of the night making love and reclaiming one another in their more modest cabin.

Cassandra felt warm all over hearing those words. “Well, I think you already did tell me that, a bunch, the night of the rave.”

“Oh, that night, I’m pretty sure I told the bathroom attendant that I loved him, too. And come to think of it, the sink and towel dispenser, maybe a couple of lamps back in my cabin, all of them might even now be waiting by the phone, expecting a call.”

“Who calls these days?”

“You’re right. A text? A... TikTok? That a thing they do these days?”

Cassandra turned her head and chuckled, low and sexy. Austin knew in that moment he could never, ever tire of that sound.

“I wasn’t exactly very discerning then.”

She cleared her throat, a move he remembered from their previous time together. She did it when she was nervous. “And now?”

He looked her in the eye and put on his best work face: the one he usually reserved for starting conversations that began with phrases such as, “We’re likely to get audited,” or, “Your permit application as outlined here will definitely get you sued.”

“I’m totally clear headed,” he said. “And Cass?” He reached for her hand. “I love you.”

Her vision blurred as tears sprang to her eyes. “I love you, too.” She took his hand and for what felt like the thousandth time, squeezed with everything she was feeling. You know, this trip somehow takes the cake for both best *and* worst vacations of my life.”

“Same.” Their laughter mingled. “But honestly,” he went on, “it was necessary. I needed something to snap me out of my doomed marriage.”

“I’m sorry that I was the one,” Cassandra said.

He waved her words away. “Don’t apologize. I’m pretty sure Faye’s been fucking around with more than just the guys she tells me about.”

“That sucks.” Cassandra snuggled close. “I will never do that.”

They both heard the future tense in that statement. They both felt its warmth.

“Marshall’s not going to give up so easily,” she said.

“Cassandra? I’m under no illusions here. If you want, we can say goodbye at the docks and—”

“What? No. Are you kidding me? I don’t know what happens next, but I’m nuts about you, and so excited to discover just what comes next for us! I’m so ready to take a step with you. And another,” she raised his hand and ran her cheek along it. “And the next one, and the one after that....”

“But Marshall. He still loves you.”

Cassandra snorted. “He loves the idea of me, maybe. But that’s not why he’s going to try and fight to keep me. He’s going to do that because we don’t have a prenup. We got married before the IPO, and what’s his is now half mine.”

“Oh.” Austin laughed. “You do know I’m a civil servant in local government, right?”

“Then it’s a good thing I’m set for life.”

Austin rolled her onto her back and climbed over her, nuzzling her nose with his. “I don’t mind being a kept man.”

Cassandra reached behind his neck and held him close. She shook her head gently. “Relationships work if the couples work at them. And I want this one to work. Okay?”

Austin nodded, kissing her tenderly. “Always.”

THE HOTWIFE CRUISE SERIES

If you enjoyed this book, you should check out the other six books in this series. Each book takes place aboard the Princess of Adventure during the same timeframe as Cassandra and Austin's story, some of the characters weaving in and out throughout. You'll recognize Jordan and Kate, the couple who thought that a hotwife was just a hot wife. You can read the Fischer String Quartet and their experiences performing aboard the Princess. And many of the ship's crew appear in various forms, including Inez and Felicity Jones.



Welcome aboard the Princess of Adventure as she embarks on a Winter cruise around the sun-drenched Caribbean! But this isn't just any seafaring trip – it's an exploration of desires and boundaries that promises to be the holiday of a lifetime! From the talented ensemble at A.C.H.E. (Authors of Cuckold and Hotwife Erotica), who previously brought you the scintillating tales of The Hotwife Key Party and The Hotwife Games, comes a thrilling

new collaboration: The Hotwife Cruise, set aboard this luxurious vessel. Prepare to dive into seven tantalizing stories, each penned by a different author, as our passengers navigate the deep waters of their fantasies and passions during this unique voyage.

- [The Hotwife Cruise: Maria by Paul Garland](#)
- [The Hotwife Cruise: Ginette by GK Grayson](#)
- [The Hotwife Cruise: Nicole by Kirsten McCurran](#)
- [The Hotwife Cruise: Kate by Skylar Quinn](#)
- [The Hotwife Cruise: Tess by Delores Swallows](#)
- [The Hotwife Cruise: Nia & Jessie by Hardison Parker](#)
- [The Hotwife Cruise: Cassandra by Kenny Wright](#)

ABOUT KENNY WRIGHT

Kenny has been publishing hotwife erotica for over ten years (and writing for much longer than that). He writes what he likes to read: steamy, explicit erotica that's just crazy enough to be true. He believes in a world where men read and appreciate erotica, and hope to contribute to it word by word.

Find him online at www.kennywriter.com, on Patreon as KennyWriter, or follow him on Twitter at @kennywriter, [Bluesky](#), and [Medium](#).



ALSO BY KENNY WRIGHT

Like what you just read? Check out these other books by Kenny Wright (or browse my catalog at <http://www.kennywriter.com/books/>).

In Too Deep



David hasn't seen his wife, Amanda, in two months—not since she went undercover on a dangerous, highly secretive case. He doesn't know where she is, what she's doing, or who she's pretending to be. He only knows he misses her—her laugh, her touch, her kiss.

Then one night, David finds himself in a strip club... and finds her on stage.

Seeing Amanda like this—seductive, confident, and far more uninhibited than he ever imagined—awakens a cocktail of emotions: confusion, desire, jealousy... and a craving for more. And then suddenly he's dragged into Amanda's dark and thrilling new world, where every move could shatter her cover—and their marriage.

Can they survive the lies, the danger, and the temptation? Or has Amanda already crossed a line that neither of them can undo?

Packed with explicit, pulse-pounding passion, intrigue, and a unique take on not just the hotwife genre, but the mystery-thriller genre, this is one story you won't forget.

***In Too Deep* is a two-part book series available everywhere that you purchase your ebooks.**

Castaway Wife: A Survival Game of Passion



Reality Television Meets Fantasy Hotwife

Have you ever wondered what it's like to be the husband to a beautiful woman on a reality television show? Millions obsessing over her. Guys on the show hitting on her. No way to interact. All you can do is watch. All you can do is hope that in the end, she comes back home.

Andy certainly never considered any of that when he encouraged his wife, Chelsea, to live her dream as a contestant on Castaway. The six weeks of separation that followed were hard enough. The months that followed were even more difficult. She wasn't allowed to talk about the show, but as each episode unfolded and he saw how close she got with Todd, a fireman from LA, he began to wonder how much was editing and how much was real.

Everything comes to a head as the final episode of the season airs before a live audience. The winner is crowned. The contestants reunite. And Andy learns just how much the spotlight has changed his wife.

[Find Castaway Wife at any major online retailers.](#)

Everyone's a Winner



Who says a couple can't have new adventures after two decades of marriage?

When Lauren heads to Las Vegas alone, Eric encourages her to explore their hotwife fantasies. What ends up happening is a series of experiences that cross lines that Lauren never thought she would, and leave Eric wondering who he married and how he got so lucky.

Follow Lauren and Eric's journey, and find out just how everyone wins.

[Find Everyone's a Winner online.](#)

The Blonde in 3C



From neighbor to friend to wife to... hotwife?

Cooper always had a crush on Annika, the blonde in apartment 3C. She was friendly. She was pretty. Best of all, she had loud sex with her boyfriend, Brett, that Cooper could hear through the floorboards. He never thought that one day, he would marry that sexy blonde.

But first impressions are hard to shake, and Cooper's first impression of his future bride was of an insatiable woman he could never fully satisfy. He was always waiting for the other shoe to drop, for a new man to take his place, for him to lose it all. A hotwife fantasy was born and it grew with their marriage.

The things that Annika did for love always surprised her, but that was just who she was. She gave all of her energy to a relationship. She'd done some wild things for her hedonistic former boyfriend, Brett. She was still trying to figure out Cooper.

When they attend Brett's wedding, Annika and Cooper are put to the test. Will Annika be tempted by the past? Will Cooper's repressed fantasy explode into the open?

[Find The Blonde in 3C online!](#)

Bull's Eye Series (5 books)



Paul Sharpe, self-avowed bachelor, works hard and plays harder—always looking for a new conquest. Blondes, brunettes, redheads, he enjoys them all as long as the pursuit is fun and they're up for a good time. He's fine being disposable. Life is simpler that way.

Until he meets a woman who opens his eyes to a whole new world—the world of hotwives and cuckolds and the games that they play. After that, he sees it everywhere. At bars, at clubs, at his company's gala, he sees men furtively watching other men hit on their wives.

Can he be the other man? Can he be the bull?

Follow Paul's epic journey over five books as he evolves from the bull to so much more.

[Bull's Eye 1: Discovering the Hotwife Fantasy](#)

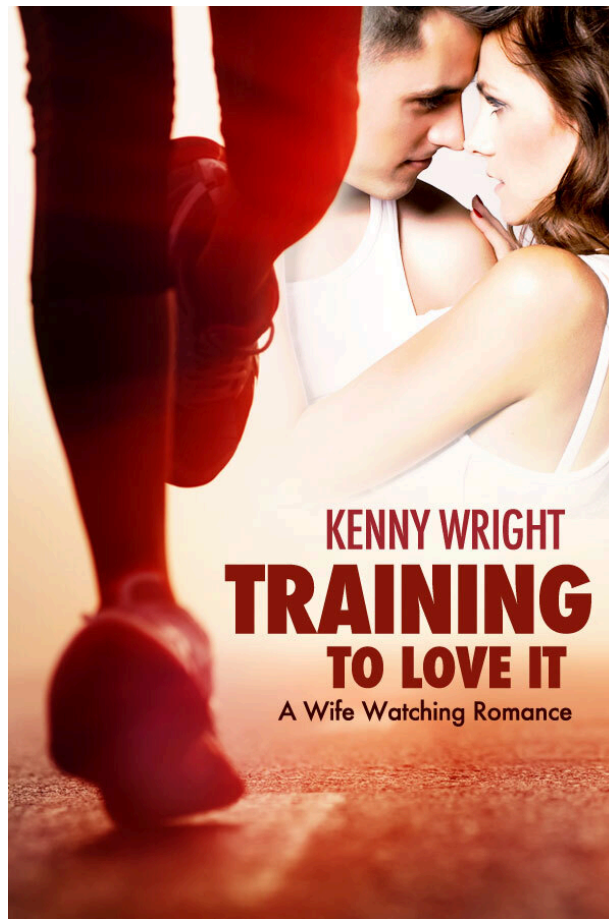
[Bull's Eye 2: Exploring the Hotwife Fantasy](#)

[Bull's Eye 3: Enjoying the Hotwife Fantasy](#)

[Bull's Eye 4: Consequences of a Hotwife Fantasy](#)

[Bull's Eye 5: Beyond the Hotwife Fantasy](#)

Training to Love It Series (3 books)



Can a wife-watching fantasy be trained?

When Erin comes home from the gym and lets slip that her new personal trainer is a man, Tom doesn't know how to react. When he overhears Erin admitting that she's attracted to AJ, her trainer, he becomes even more confused. He wants to be supportive, but he feels jealous. He wants to be understanding, but he doesn't even understand his own feelings. Every time he thinks of Erin with AJ, his heart begins to race. Every time she says his name, his breath catches in his chest.

AJ ends up pushing more than just his wife's physical limits. As Tom watches this newer, stronger, more assertive woman emerge with each training session, he realizes that this other man is pushing the limits of their marriage and their happy life. How far would they go for a fantasy? And whose fantasy is it? And what happens when things go too far?

[Training to Love It series](#)